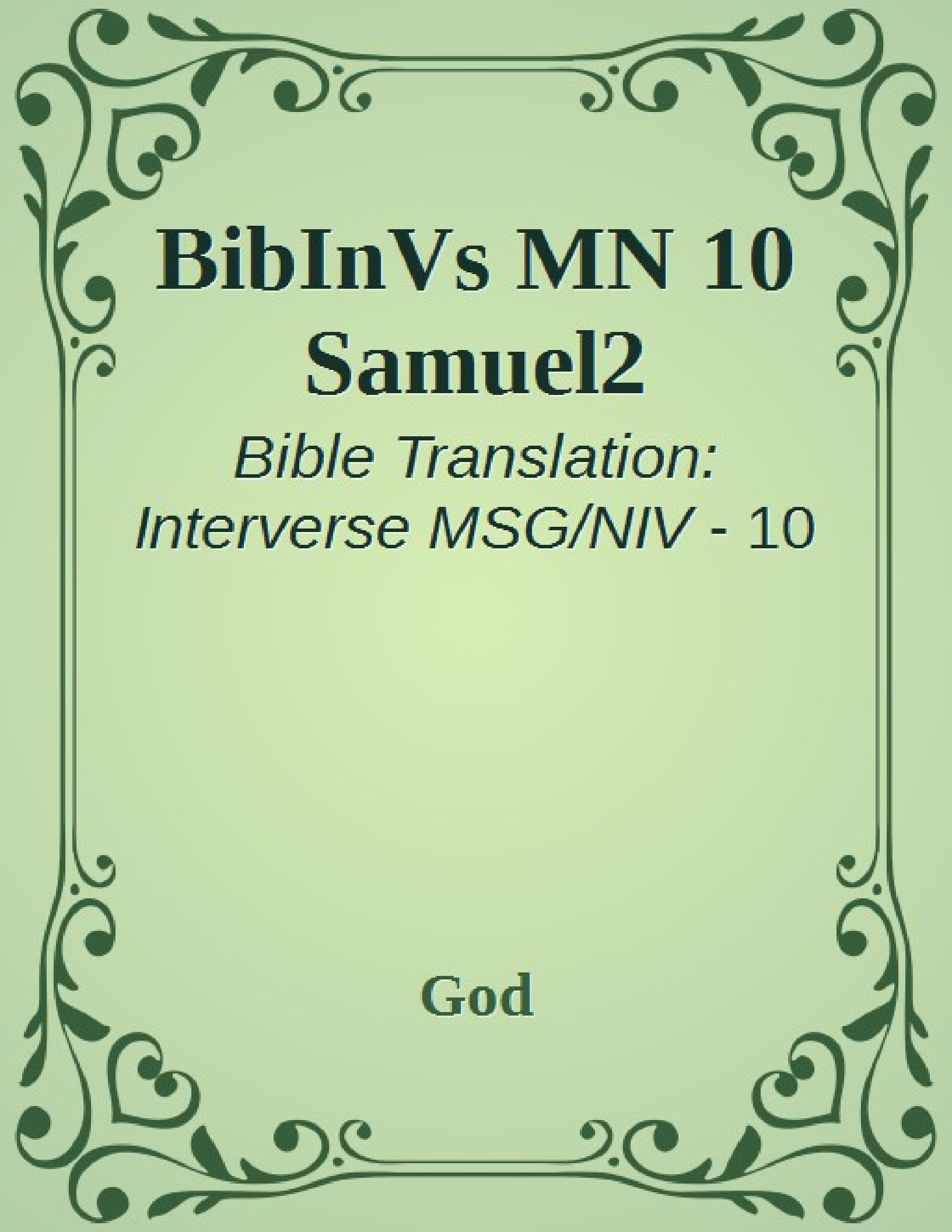


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 10

Samuel2

Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 10

God

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2 Samuel

2 Samuel 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 Shortly after Saul died, David returned to Ziklag from his rout of the Amalekites.
- 1 After the death of Saul, David returned from defeating the Amalekites and stayed in Ziklag two days.
- 2 Three days later a man showed up unannounced from Saul's army camp. Disheveled and obviously in mourning, he fell to his knees in respect before David.
- 2 On the third day a man arrived from Saul's camp, with his clothes torn and with dust on his head. When he came to David, he fell to the ground to pay him honor.
- 3 David asked, "What brings you here?" He answered, "I've just escaped from the camp of Israel."
- 3 Where have you come from? David asked him. He answered, "I have escaped from the Israelite camp."
- 4 "So what happened?" said David. "What's the news?" He said, "The Israelites have fled the battlefield, leaving a lot of their dead comrades behind. And Saul and his son Jonathan are dead."
- 4 What happened? David asked. "Tell me." He said, "The men fled from the battle. Many of them fell and died. And Saul and his son Jonathan are dead."
- 5 David pressed the young soldier for details: "How do you know for sure that Saul and Jonathan are dead?"
- 5 Then David said to the young man who brought him the report, "How do you know that Saul and his son Jonathan are dead?"
- 6 "I just happened by Mount Gilboa and came on Saul, badly wounded and leaning on his spear, with enemy chariots and horsemen bearing down hard on him.

- 6 I happened to be on Mount Gilboa, the young man said, "and there was Saul, leaning on his spear, with the chariots and riders almost upon him.
- 7 He looked behind him, saw me, and called me to him. 'Yes sir,' I said, 'at your service.'
- 7 When he turned around and saw me, he called out to me, and I said, 'What can I do?'
- 8 He asked me who I was, and I told him, 'I'm an Amalekite.'"
- 8 He asked me, 'Who are you?' 'An Amalekite,' I answered.
- 9 "Come here," he said, "and put me out of my misery. I'm nearly dead already, but my life hangs on."
- 9 Then he said to me, 'Stand over me and kill me! I am in the throes of death, but I'm still alive.'
- 10 "So I did what he asked--I killed him. I knew he wouldn't last much longer anyway. I removed his royal headband and bracelet, and have brought them to my master. Here they are."
- 10 So I stood over him and killed him, because I knew that after he had fallen he could not survive. And I took the crown that was on his head and the band on his arm and have brought them here to my lord.
- 11 In lament, David ripped his clothes to ribbons. All the men with him did the same.
- 11 Then David and all the men with him took hold of their clothes and tore them.
- 12 They wept and fasted the rest of the day, grieving the death of Saul and his son Jonathan, and also the army of GOD and the nation Israel, victims in a failed battle.
- 12 They mourned and wept and fasted till evening for Saul and his son Jonathan, and for the army of the LORD and the house of Israel, because they had fallen by the sword.
- 13 Then David spoke to the young soldier who had brought the report: "Who are you, anyway?" "I'm from an immigrant family--an Amalekite."
- 13 David said to the young man who brought him the report, "Where are you from?" "I am the son of an alien, an Amalekite," he answered.
- 14 "Do you mean to say," said David, "that you weren't afraid to up and kill GOD's anointed king?"
- 14 David asked him, "Why were you not afraid to lift your hand to destroy the LORD's anointed?"

15 Right then he ordered one of his soldiers, "Strike him dead!" The soldier struck him, and he died.

15 Then David called one of his men and said, "Go, strike him down!" So he struck him down, and he died.

16 "You asked for it," David told him. "You sealed your death sentence when you said you killed GOD's anointed king."

16 For David had said to him, "Your blood be on your own head. Your own mouth testified against you when you said, 'I killed the LORD's anointed.' "

17 Then David sang this lament over Saul and his son Jonathan,

17 David took up this lament concerning Saul and his son Jonathan,

18 and gave orders that everyone in Judah learn it by heart. Yes, it's even inscribed in The Book of Jashar.

18 and ordered that the men of Judah be taught this lament of the bow (it is written in the Book of Jashar):

19 Oh, oh, Gazelles of Israel, struck down on your hills, the mighty warriors--fallen, fallen!

19 Your glory, O Israel, lies slain on your heights. How the mighty have fallen!

20 Don't announce it in the city of Gath, don't post the news in the streets of Ashkelon. Don't give those coarse Philistine girls one more excuse for a drunken party!

20 Tell it not in Gath, proclaim it not in the streets of Ashkelon, lest the daughters of the Philistines be glad, lest the daughters of the uncircumcised rejoice.

21 No more dew or rain for you, hills of Gilboa, and not a drop from springs and wells, For there the warriors' shields were dragged through the mud, Saul's shield left there to rot.

21 O mountains of Gilboa, may you have neither dew nor rain, nor fields that yield offerings of grain. For there the shield of the mighty was defiled, the shield of Saul--no longer rubbed with oil.

22 Jonathan's bow was bold-- the bigger they were the harder they fell. Saul's sword was fearless-- once out of the scabbard, nothing could stop it.

22 From the blood of the slain, from the flesh of the mighty, the bow of Jonathan did not turn back, the sword of Saul did not return unsatisfied.

- 23 Saul and Jonathan--beloved, beautiful! Together in life, together in death. Swifter than plummeting eagles, stronger than proud lions.
- 23 Saul and Jonathan-- in life they were loved and gracious, and in death they were not parted. They were swifter than eagles, they were stronger than lions.
- 24 Women of Israel, weep for Saul. He dressed you in finest cottons and silks, spared no expense in making you elegant.
- 24 O daughters of Israel, weep for Saul, who clothed you in scarlet and finery, who adorned your garments with ornaments of gold.
- 25 The mighty warriors--fallen, fallen in the middle of the fight! Jonathan--struck down on your hills!
- 25 How the mighty have fallen in battle! Jonathan lies slain on your heights.
- 26 O my dear brother Jonathan, I'm crushed by your death. Your friendship was a miracle-wonder, love far exceeding anything I've known-- or ever hope to know.
- 26 I grieve for you, Jonathan my brother; you were very dear to me. Your love for me was wonderful, more wonderful than that of women.
- 27 The mighty warriors--fallen, fallen. And the arms of war broken to bits.
- 27 How the mighty have fallen! The weapons of war have perished!

2 Samuel 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 After all this, David prayed. He asked God, "Shall I move to one of the cities of Judah?" GOD said, "Yes, move." "And to which city?" "To Hebron."
- 1 In the course of time, David inquired of the LORD. "Shall I go up to one of the towns of Judah?" he asked. The LORD said, "Go up." David asked, "Where shall I go?" "To Hebron," the LORD answered.
- 2 So David moved to Hebron, along with his two wives, Ahinoam of Jezreel and Abigail the widow of Nabal of Carmel.
- 2 So David went up there with his two wives, Ahinoam of Jezreel and Abigail, the widow of Nabal of Carmel.

- 3 David's men, along with their families, also went with him and made their home in and around Hebron.
- 3 David also took the men who were with him, each with his family, and they settled in Hebron and its towns.
- 4 The citizens of Judah came to Hebron, and then and there made David king over the clans of Judah. A report was brought to David that the men of Jabesh Gilead had given Saul a decent burial.
- 4 Then the men of Judah came to Hebron and there they anointed David king over the house of Judah. When David was told that it was the men of Jabesh Gilead who had buried Saul,
- 5 David sent messengers to the men of Jabesh Gilead: "GOD bless you for this--for honoring your master, Saul, with a funeral.
- 5 he sent messengers to the men of Jabesh Gilead to say to them, "The LORD bless you for showing this kindness to Saul your master by burying him.
- 6 GOD honor you and be true to you--and I'll do the same, matching your generous act of goodness.
- 6 May the LORD now show you kindness and faithfulness, and I too will show you the same favor because you have done this.
- 7 Strengthen your resolve and do what must be done. Your master, Saul, is dead. The citizens of Judah have made me their king."
- 7 Now then, be strong and brave, for Saul your master is dead, and the house of Judah has anointed me king over them."
- 8 In the meantime, Abner son of Ner, commander of Saul's army, had taken Saul's son Ish-Bosheth to Mahanaim
- 8 Meanwhile, Abner son of Ner, the commander of Saul's army, had taken Ish-Bosheth son of Saul and brought him over to Mahanaim.
- 9 and made him king over Gilead, over Asher, over Jezreel, over Ephraim, over Benjamin--king, as it turns out, over all Israel.
- 9 He made him king over Gilead, Ashuri and Jezreel, and also over Ephraim, Benjamin and all Israel.
- 10 Ish-Bosheth, Saul's son, was forty years old when he was made king over Israel. He lasted only two years. But the people of Judah stuck with David.
- 10 Ish-Bosheth son of Saul was forty years old when he became king over Israel, and he reigned two years. The house of Judah, however, followed

David.

- 11 David ruled the people of Judah from Hebron for seven and a half years.
- 11 The length of time David was king in Hebron over the house of Judah was seven years and six months.
- 12 One day Abner son of Ner set out from Mahanaim with the soldiers of Ish-Bosheth son of Saul, headed for Gibeon.
- 12 Abner son of Ner, together with the men of Ish-Bosheth son of Saul, left Mahanaim and went to Gibeon.
- 13 Joab son of Zeruiah, with David's soldiers, also set out. They met at the Pool of Gibeon, Abner's group on one side, Joab's on the other.
- 13 Joab son of Zeruiah and David's men went out and met them at the pool of Gibeon. One group sat down on one side of the pool and one group on the other side.
- 14 Abner challenged Joab, "Put up your best fighters. Let's see them do their stuff." Joab said, "Good! Let them go at it!"
- 14 Then Abner said to Joab, "Let's have some of the young men get up and fight hand to hand in front of us." "All right, let them do it," Joab said.
- 15 So they lined up for the fight, twelve Benjaminites from the side of Ish-Bosheth son of Saul, and twelve soldiers from David's side.
- 15 So they stood up and were counted off--twelve men for Benjamin and Ish-Bosheth son of Saul, and twelve for David.
- 16 The men from each side grabbed their opponents' heads and stabbed them with their daggers. They all fell dead--the whole bunch together. So, they called the place Slaughter Park. It's right there at Gibeon.
- 16 Then each man grabbed his opponent by the head and thrust his dagger into his opponent's side, and they fell down together. So that place in Gibeon was called Helkath Hazzurim.
- 17 The fighting went from bad to worse throughout the day. Abner and the men of Israel were beaten to a pulp by David's men.
- 17 The battle that day was very fierce, and Abner and the men of Israel were defeated by David's men.
- 18 The three sons of Zeruiah were present: Joab, Abishai, and Asahel. Asahel, as fast as a wild antelope
- 18 The three sons of Zeruiah were there: Joab, Abishai and Asahel. Now Asahel was as fleet-footed as a wild gazelle.
- 19 on the open plain, chased Abner, staying hard on his heels.

- 19 He chased Abner, turning neither to the right nor to the left as he pursued him.
- 20 Abner turned and said, "Is that you, Asahel?" "It surely is," he said.
- 20 Abner looked behind him and asked, "Is that you, Asahel?" "It is," he answered.
- 21 Abner said, "Let up on me. Pick on someone you have a chance of beating and be content with those spoils!" But Asahel wouldn't let up.
- 21 Then Abner said to him, "Turn aside to the right or to the left; take on one of the young men and strip him of his weapons." But Asahel would not stop chasing him.
- 22 Abner tried again, "Turn back. Don't force me to kill you. How would I face your brother Joab?"
- 22 Again Abner warned Asahel, "Stop chasing me! Why should I strike you down? How could I look your brother Joab in the face?"
- 23 When he refused to quit, Abner struck him in the belly with the blunt end of his spear so hard that it came out his back. Asahel fell to the ground and died at once. Everyone who arrived at the spot where Asahel fell and died stood and gaped--Asahel dead!
- 23 But Asahel refused to give up the pursuit; so Abner thrust the butt of his spear into Asahel's stomach, and the spear came out through his back. He fell there and died on the spot. And every man stopped when he came to the place where Asahel had fallen and died.
- 24 But Joab and Abishai kept up the chase after Abner. As the sun began to set, they came to the hill of Ammah that faced Giah on the road to the backcountry of Gibeon.
- 24 But Joab and Abishai pursued Abner, and as the sun was setting, they came to the hill of Ammah, near Giah on the way to the wasteland of Gibeon.
- 25 The Benjaminites had taken their stand with Abner there, deployed strategically on a hill.
- 25 Then the men of Benjamin rallied behind Abner. They formed themselves into a group and took their stand on top of a hill.
- 26 Abner called out to Joab, "Are we going to keep killing each other till doomsday? Don't you know that nothing but bitterness will come from this? How long before you call off your men from chasing their brothers?"

- 26 Abner called out to Joab, "Must the sword devour forever? Don't you realize that this will end in bitterness? How long before you order your men to stop pursuing their brothers?"
- 27 "As God lives," said Joab, "if you hadn't spoken up, we'd have kept up the chase until morning!"
- 27 Joab answered, "As surely as God lives, if you had not spoken, the men would have continued the pursuit of their brothers until morning. "
- 28 Then he blew the ram's horn trumpet and the whole army of Judah stopped in its tracks. They quit chasing Israel and called off the fighting.
- 28 So Joab blew the trumpet, and all the men came to a halt; they no longer pursued Israel, nor did they fight anymore.
- 29 Abner and his soldiers marched all that night up the Arabah Valley. They crossed the Jordan and, after a long morning's march, arrived at Mahanaim.
- 29 All that night Abner and his men marched through the Arabah. They crossed the Jordan, continued through the whole Bithron and came to Mahanaim.
- 30 After Joab returned from chasing Abner, he took a head count of the army. Nineteen of David's men (besides Asahel) were missing.
- 30 Then Joab returned from pursuing Abner and assembled all his men. Besides Asahel, nineteen of David's men were found missing.
- 31 David's men had cut down three hundred and sixty of Abner's men, all Benjaminites--all dead.
- 31 But David's men had killed three hundred and sixty Benjamites who were with Abner.
- 32 They brought Asahel and buried him in the family tomb in Bethlehem. Joab and his men then marched all night, arriving in Hebron as the dawn broke.
- 32 They took Asahel and buried him in his father's tomb at Bethlehem. Then Joab and his men marched all night and arrived at Hebron by daybreak.

2 Samuel 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 The war between the house of Saul and the house of David dragged on and on. The longer it went on the stronger David became, with the house of Saul getting weaker.
- 1 The war between the house of Saul and the house of David lasted a long time. David grew stronger and stronger, while the house of Saul grew weaker and weaker.
- 2 During the Hebron years, sons were born to David: Amnon, born of Ahinoam of Jezreel--the firstborn;
- 2 Sons were born to David in Hebron: His firstborn was Amnon the son of Ahinoam of Jezreel;
- 3 Kileab, born of Abigail of Carmel, Nabal's widow--his second; Absalom, born of Maacah, daughter of Talmai, king of Geshur--the third;
- 3 his second, Kileab the son of Abigail the widow of Nabal of Carmel; the third, Absalom the son of Maacah daughter of Talmai king of Geshur;
- 4 Adonijah, born of Haggith--the fourth; Shephatiah, born of Abital--the fifth;
- 4 the fourth, Adonijah the son of Haggith; the fifth, Shephatiah the son of Abital;
- 5 Ithream, born of Eglah--the sixth. These six sons of David were born in Hebron.
- 5 and the sixth, Ithream the son of David's wife Eglah. These were born to David in Hebron.
- 6 Abner took advantage of the continuing war between the house of Saul and the house of David to gain power for himself.
- 6 During the war between the house of Saul and the house of David, Abner had been strengthening his own position in the house of Saul.
- 7 Saul had had a concubine, Rizpah, the daughter of Aiah. One day Ish-Bosheth confronted Abner: "What business do you have sleeping with my father's concubine?"
- 7 Now Saul had had a concubine named Rizpah daughter of Aiah. And Ish-Bosheth said to Abner, "Why did you sleep with my father's concubine?"
- 8 Abner lost his temper with Ish-Bosheth, "Treat me like a dog, will you! Is this the thanks I get for sticking by the house of your father, Saul, and all his family and friends? I personally saved you from certain capture by David, and you make an issue out of my going to bed with a woman!

- 8 Abner was very angry because of what Ish-Bosheth said and he answered, "Am I a dog's head--on Judah's side? This very day I am loyal to the house of your father Saul and to his family and friends. I haven't handed you over to David. Yet now you accuse me of an offense involving this woman!"
- 9 What GOD promised David, I'll help accomplish--transfer the kingdom from the house of Saul and make David ruler over the whole country, both Israel and Judah, from Dan to Beersheba. If not, may God do his worst to me."
- 9 May God deal with Abner, be it ever so severely, if I do not do for David what the LORD promised him on oath
- 10 (SEE 3:9)
- 10 and transfer the kingdom from the house of Saul and establish David's throne over Israel and Judah from Dan to Beersheba."
- 11 Ish-Bosheth, cowed by Abner's outburst, couldn't say another word.
- 11 Ish- Bosheth did not dare to say another word to Abner, because he was afraid of him.
- 12 Abner went ahead and sent personal messengers to David: "Make a deal with me and I'll help bring the whole country of Israel over to you."
- 12 Then Abner sent messengers on his behalf to say to David, "Whose land is it? Make an agreement with me, and I will help you bring all Israel over to you."
- 13 "Great," said David. "It's a deal. But only on one condition: You're not welcome here unless you bring Michal, Saul's daughter, with you when you come to meet me."
- 13 Good, said David. "I will make an agreement with you. But I demand one thing of you: Do not come into my presence unless you bring Michal daughter of Saul when you come to see me."
- 14 David then sent messengers to Ish-Bosheth son of Saul: "Give me back Michal, whom I won as my wife at the cost of a hundred Philistine foreskins."
- 14 Then David sent messengers to Ish-Bosheth son of Saul, demanding, "Give me my wife Michal, whom I betrothed to myself for the price of a hundred Philistine foreskins."
- 15 Ish-Bosheth ordered that she be taken from her husband Paltiel son of Laish.

- 15 So Ish-Bosheth gave orders and had her taken away from her husband Paltiel son of Laish.
- 16 But Paltiel followed her, weeping all the way, to Bahurim. There Abner told him, "Go home." And he went home.
- 16 Her husband, however, went with her, weeping behind her all the way to Bahurim. Then Abner said to him, "Go back home!" So he went back.
- 17 Abner got the elders of Israel together and said, "Only yesterday, it seems, you were looking for a way to make David your king.
- 17 Abner conferred with the elders of Israel and said, "For some time you have wanted to make David your king.
- 18 So do it--now! For GOD has given the go-ahead on David: 'By my servant David's hand, I'll save my people Israel from the oppression of the Philistines and all their other enemies.'"
- 18 Now do it! For the LORD promised David, 'By my servant David I will rescue my people Israel from the hand of the Philistines and from the hand of all their enemies.' "
- 19 Abner took the Benjaminites aside and spoke to them. Then he went to Hebron for a private talk with David, telling him everything that Israel in general and Benjamin in particular were planning to do.
- 19 Abner also spoke to the Benjaminites in person. Then he went to Hebron to tell David everything that Israel and the whole house of Benjamin wanted to do.
- 20 When Abner and the twenty men who were with him met with David in Hebron, David laid out a feast for them.
- 20 When Abner, who had twenty men with him, came to David at Hebron, David prepared a feast for him and his men.
- 21 Abner then said, "I'm ready. Let me go now to rally everyone in Israel for my master, the king. They'll make a treaty with you, authorizing you to rule them however you see fit." Abner was sent off with David's blessing.
- 21 Then Abner said to David, "Let me go at once and assemble all Israel for my lord the king, so that they may make a compact with you, and that you may rule over all that your heart desires." So David sent Abner away, and he went in peace.
- 22 Soon after that, David's men, led by Joab, came back from a field assignment. Abner was no longer in Hebron with David, having just

been dismissed with David's blessing.

22 Just then David's men and Joab returned from a raid and brought with them a great deal of plunder. But Abner was no longer with David in Hebron, because David had sent him away, and he had gone in peace.

23 As Joab and his raiding party arrived, they were told that Abner the son of Ner had been there with David and had been sent off with David's blessing.

23 When Joab and all the soldiers with him arrived, he was told that Abner son of Ner had come to the king and that the king had sent him away and that he had gone in peace.

24 Joab went straight to the king: "What's this you've done? Abner shows up, and you let him walk away scot-free?"

24 So Joab went to the king and said, "What have you done? Look, Abner came to you. Why did you let him go? Now he is gone!"

25 You know Abner son of Ner better than that. This was no friendly visit. He was here to spy on you, figure out your comings and goings, find out what you're up to."

25 You know Abner son of Ner; he came to deceive you and observe your movements and find out everything you are doing."

26 Joab left David and went into action. He sent messengers after Abner; they caught up with him at the well at Sirah and brought him back. David knew nothing of all this.

26 Joab then left David and sent messengers after Abner, and they brought him back from the well of Sirah. But David did not know it.

27 When Abner got back to Hebron, Joab steered him aside at the gate for a personal word with him. There he stabbed him in the belly, killed him in cold blood for the murder of his brother Asahel.

27 Now when Abner returned to Hebron, Joab took him aside into the gateway, as though to speak with him privately. And there, to avenge the blood of his brother Asahel, Joab stabbed him in the stomach, and he died.

28 Later on, when David heard what happened, he said, "Before GOD I and my kingdom are totally innocent of this murder of Abner son of Ner.

28 Later, when David heard about this, he said, "I and my kingdom are forever innocent before the LORD concerning the blood of Abner son of Ner.

- 29 Joab and his entire family will always be under the curse of this bloodguilt. May they forever be victims of crippling diseases, violence, and famine."
- 29 May his blood fall upon the head of Joab and upon all his father's house! May Joab's house never be without someone who has a running sore or leprosy or who leans on a crutch or who falls by the sword or who lacks food."
- 30 (Joab and his brother, Abishai, murdered Abner because he had killed their brother Asahel at the battle of Gibeon.)
- 30 (Joab and his brother Abishai murdered Abner because he had killed their brother Asahel in the battle at Gibeon.)
- 31 David ordered Joab and all the men under him, "Rip your cloaks into rags! Wear mourning clothes! Lead Abner's funeral procession with loud lament!" King David followed the coffin.
- 31 Then David said to Joab and all the people with him, "Tear your clothes and put on sackcloth and walk in mourning in front of Abner." King David himself walked behind the bier.
- 32 They buried Abner in Hebron. The king's voice was loud in lament as he wept at the side of Abner's grave. All the people wept, too.
- 32 They buried Abner in Hebron, and the king wept aloud at Abner's tomb. All the people wept also.
- 33 Then the king sang this tribute to Abner: Can this be? Abner dead like a nameless bum?
- 33 The king sang this lament for Abner: "Should Abner have died as the lawless die?
- 34 You were a free man, free to go and do as you wished-- Yet you fell as a victim in a street brawl. And all the people wept--a crescendo of crying!
- 34 Your hands were not bound, your feet were not fettered. You fell as one falls before wicked men." And all the people wept over him again.
- 35 They all came then to David, trying to get him to eat something before dark. But David solemnly swore, "I'll not so much as taste a piece of bread, or anything else for that matter, before sunset, so help me God!"
- 35 Then they all came and urged David to eat something while it was still day; but David took an oath, saying, "May God deal with me, be it ever so severely, if I taste bread or anything else before the sun sets!"

- 36 Everyone at the funeral took notice--and liked what they saw. In fact everything the king did was applauded by the people.
- 36 All the people took note and were pleased; indeed, everything the king did pleased them.
- 37 It was clear to everyone that day, including all Israel, that the king had nothing to do with the death of Abner son of Ner.
- 37 So on that day all the people and all Israel knew that the king had no part in the murder of Abner son of Ner.
- 38 The king spoke to his servants: "You realize, don't you, that today a prince and hero fell victim of foul play in Israel?"
- 38 Then the king said to his men, "Do you not realize that a prince and a great man has fallen in Israel this day?"
- 39 And I, though anointed king, was helpless to do anything about it. These sons of Zeruiah are too much for me. GOD, requite the criminal for his crime!"
- 39 And today, though I am the anointed king, I am weak, and these sons of Zeruiah are too strong for me. May the LORD repay the evildoer according to his evil deeds!"

2 Samuel 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Saul's son, Ish-Bosheth, heard that Abner had died in Hebron. His heart sank. The whole country was shaken.
- 1 When Ish-Bosheth son of Saul heard that Abner had died in Hebron, he lost courage, and all Israel became alarmed.
- 2 Ish-Bosheth had two men who were captains of raiding bands--one was named Baanah, the other Recab. They were sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, a Benjaminite. (The people of Beeroth had been assigned to Benjamin
- 2 Now Saul's son had two men who were leaders of raiding bands. One was named Baanah and the other Recab; they were sons of Rimmon the Beerothite from the tribe of Benjamin--Beeroth is considered part of Benjamin,

- 3 ever since they escaped to Gittaim. They still live there as resident aliens.)
- 3 because the people of Beeroth fled to Gittaim and have lived there as aliens to this day.
- 4 It so happened that Saul's son, Jonathan, had a son who was maimed in both feet. When he was five years old, the report on Saul and Jonathan came from Jezreel. His nurse picked him up and ran, but in her hurry to get away she fell, and the boy was maimed. His name was Mephibosheth.
- 4 (Jonathan son of Saul had a son who was lame in both feet. He was five years old when the news about Saul and Jonathan came from Jezreel. His nurse picked him up and fled, but as she hurried to leave, he fell and became crippled. His name was Mephibosheth.)
- 5 One day Baanah and Recab, the two sons of Rimmon, headed out for the house of Ish-Bosheth. They arrived at the hottest time of the day, just as he was taking his afternoon nap.
- 5 Now Recab and Baanah, the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, set out for the house of Ish-Bosheth, and they arrived there in the heat of the day while he was taking his noonday rest.
- 6 They entered the house on a ruse, pretending official business. The maid guarding the bedroom had fallen asleep, so Recab and Baanah slipped by her
- 6 They went into the inner part of the house as if to get some wheat, and they stabbed him in the stomach. Then Recab and his brother Baanah slipped away.
- 7 and entered the room where Ish-Bosheth was asleep on his bed. They killed him and then cut off his head, carrying it off as a trophy. They traveled all night long, taking the route through the Arabah Valley.
- 7 They had gone into the house while he was lying on the bed in his bedroom. After they stabbed and killed him, they cut off his head. Taking it with them, they traveled all night by way of the Arabah.
- 8 They presented the head of Ish-Bosheth to David at Hebron, telling the king, "Here's the head of Ish-Bosheth, Saul's son, your enemy. He was out to kill you, but GOD has given vengeance to my master, the king--vengeance this very day on Saul and his children!"

- 8 They brought the head of Ish-Bosheth to David at Hebron and said to the king, "Here is the head of Ish-Bosheth son of Saul, your enemy, who tried to take your life. This day the LORD has avenged my lord the king against Saul and his offspring."
- 9 David answered the brothers Recab and Baanah, sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, "As surely as GOD lives--the One who got me out of every trouble I've ever been in--
- 9 David answered Recab and his brother Baanah, the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, "As surely as the LORD lives, who has delivered me out of all trouble,
- 10 when the messenger told me, 'Good news! Saul is dead!' supposing I'd be delighted, I arrested him and killed him on the spot in Ziklag. That's what he got for his so-called good news!
- 10 when a man told me, 'Saul is dead,' and thought he was bringing good news, I seized him and put him to death in Ziklag. That was the reward I gave him for his news!
- 11 And now you show up--evil men who killed an innocent man in cold blood, a man asleep in his own house! Don't think I won't find you guilty of murder and rid the country of you!"
- 11 How much more--when wicked men have killed an innocent man in his own house and on his own bed--should I not now demand his blood from your hand and rid the earth of you!"
- 12 David then issued orders to his soldiers. They killed the two--chopped off their hands and feet, and hung the corpses at the pool in Hebron. But Ish-Bosheth's head they took and buried in Abner's tomb in Hebron.
- 12 So David gave an order to his men, and they killed them. They cut off their hands and feet and hung the bodies by the pool in Hebron. But they took the head of Ish-Bosheth and buried it in Abner's tomb at Hebron.

2 Samuel 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 Before long all the tribes of Israel approached David in Hebron and said, "Look at us--your own flesh and blood!

- 1 All the tribes of Israel came to David at Hebron and said, "We are your own flesh and blood.
- 2 In time past when Saul was our king, you're the one who really ran the country. Even then GOD said to you, 'You will shepherd my people Israel and you'll be the prince.'"
- 2 In the past, while Saul was king over us, you were the one who led Israel on their military campaigns. And the LORD said to you, 'You will shepherd my people Israel, and you will become their ruler.' "
- 3 All the leaders of Israel met with King David at Hebron, and the king made a treaty with them in the presence of GOD. And so they anointed David king over Israel.
- 3 When all the elders of Israel had come to King David at Hebron, the king made a compact with them at Hebron before the LORD, and they anointed David king over Israel.
- 4 David was thirty years old when he became king, and ruled for forty years.
- 4 David was thirty years old when he became king, and he reigned forty years.
- 5 In Hebron he ruled Judah for seven and a half years. In Jerusalem he ruled all Israel and Judah for thirty-three years.
- 5 In Hebron he reigned over Judah seven years and six months, and in Jerusalem he reigned over all Israel and Judah thirty-three years.
- 6 David and his men immediately set out for Jerusalem to take on the Jebusites, who lived in that country. But they said, "You might as well go home! Even the blind and the lame could keep you out. You can't get in here!" They had convinced themselves that David couldn't break through.
- 6 The king and his men marched to Jerusalem to attack the Jebusites, who lived there. The Jebusites said to David, "You will not get in here; even the blind and the lame can ward you off." They thought, "David cannot get in here."
- 7 But David went right ahead and captured the fortress of Zion, known ever since as the City of David.
- 7 Nevertheless, David captured the fortress of Zion, the City of David.
- 8 That day David said, "To get the best of these Jebusites, one must target the water system, not to mention this so-called lame and blind bunch that

- David hates." (In fact, he was so sick and tired of it, people coined the expression, "No lame and blind allowed in the palace.")
- 8 On that day, David said, "Anyone who conquers the Jebusites will have to use the water shaft to reach those 'lame and blind' who are David's enemies. " That is why they say, "The 'blind and lame' will not enter the palace."
- 9 David made the fortress city his home and named it "City of David." He developed the city from the outside terraces inward.
- 9 David then took up residence in the fortress and called it the City of David. He built up the area around it, from the supporting terraces inward.
- 10 David proceeded with a longer stride, a larger embrace since the GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies was with him.
- 10 And he became more and more powerful, because the LORD God Almighty was with him.
- 11 It was at this time that Hiram, king of Tyre, sent messengers to David, along with timbers of cedar. He also sent carpenters and masons to build a house for David.
- 11 Now Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, along with cedar logs and carpenters and stonemasons, and they built a palace for David.
- 12 David took this as a sign that GOD had confirmed him as king of Israel, giving his kingship world prominence for the sake of Israel, his people.
- 12 And David knew that the LORD had established him as king over Israel and had exalted his kingdom for the sake of his people Israel.
- 13 David took on more concubines and wives from Jerusalem after he left Hebron. And more sons and daughters were born to him.
- 13 After he left Hebron, David took more concubines and wives in Jerusalem, and more sons and daughters were born to him.
- 14 These are the names of those born to him in Jerusalem: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon,
- 14 These are the names of the children born to him there: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon,
- 15 Ibhar, Elishua, Nepheg, Japhia,
- 15 Ibhar, Elishua, Nepheg, Japhia,
- 16 Elishama, Eliada, Eliphelet.
- 16 Elishama, Eliada and Eliphelet.

- 17 When the Philistines got word that David had been made king over all Israel, they came on the hunt for him. David heard of it and went down to the stronghold.
- 17 When the Philistines heard that David had been anointed king over Israel, they went up in full force to search for him, but David heard about it and went down to the stronghold.
- 18 When the Philistines arrived, they deployed their forces in Rephaim Valley.
- 18 Now the Philistines had come and spread out in the Valley of Rephaim;
- 19 Then David prayed to GOD: "Shall I go up and fight the Philistines? Will you help me beat them?"
- 19 so David inquired of the LORD, "Shall I go and attack the Philistines? Will you hand them over to me?" The LORD answered him, "Go, for I will surely hand the Philistines over to you."
- 20 "Go up," GOD replied. "Count on me. I'll help you beat them." David then went straight to Baal Perazim, and smashed them to pieces. Afterwards David said, "GOD exploded on my enemies like a gush of water." That's why David named the place Baal Perazim (The-Master-Who-Explodes).
- 20 So David went to Baal Perazim, and there he defeated them. He said, "As waters break out, the LORD has broken out against my enemies before me." So that place was called Baal Perazim.
- 21 The retreating Philistines dumped their idols, and David and his soldiers took them away.
- 21 The Philistines abandoned their idols there, and David and his men carried them off.
- 22 Later there was a repeat performance. The Philistines came up again and deployed their troops in the Rephaim Valley.
- 22 Once more the Philistines came up and spread out in the Valley of Rephaim;
- 23 David again prayed to GOD. This time GOD said, "Don't attack them head-on. Instead, circle around behind them and ambush them from the grove of sacred trees.
- 23 so David inquired of the LORD, and he answered, "Do not go straight up, but circle around behind them and attack them in front of the balsam trees.

- 24 When you hear the sound of shuffling in the trees, get ready to move out. It's a signal that GOD is going ahead of you to smash the Philistine camp."
- 24 As soon as you hear the sound of marching in the tops of the balsam trees, move quickly, because that will mean the LORD has gone out in front of you to strike the Philistine army."
- 25 David did exactly what GOD told him. He routed the Philistines all the way from Gibeon to Gezer.
- 25 So David did as the LORD commanded him, and he struck down the Philistines all the way from Gibeon to Gezer.

2 Samuel 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 David mustered the pick of the troops of Israel--thirty divisions of them.
- 1 David again brought together out of Israel chosen men, thirty thousand in all.
- 2 Together with his soldiers, David headed for Baalah to recover the Chest of God, which was called by the Name GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, who was enthroned over the pair of angels on the Chest.
- 2 He and all his men set out from Baalah of Judah to bring up from there the ark of God, which is called by the Name, the name of the LORD Almighty, who is enthroned between the cherubim that are on the ark.
- 3 They placed the Chest of God on a brand-new oxcart and removed it from Abinadab's house on the hill. Uzzah and Ahio, Abinadab's sons, were driving the new cart
- 3 They set the ark of God on a new cart and brought it from the house of Abinadab, which was on the hill. Uzzah and Ahio, sons of Abinadab, were guiding the new cart
- 4 loaded with the Chest of God, Ahio in the lead and Uzzah alongside the Chest.
- 4 with the ark of God on it, and Ahio was walking in front of it.
- 5 David and the whole company of Israel were in the parade, singing at the top of their lungs and playing mandolins, harps, tambourines, castanets, and cymbals.

- 5 David and the whole house of Israel were celebrating with all their might before the LORD, with songs and with harps, lyres, tambourines, sistrums and cymbals.
- 6 When they came to the threshing floor of Nacon, the oxen stumbled, so Uzzah reached out and grabbed the Chest of God.
- 6 When they came to the threshing floor of Nacon, Uzzah reached out and took hold of the ark of God, because the oxen stumbled.
- 7 GOD blazed in anger against Uzzah and struck him hard because he had profaned the Chest. Uzzah died on the spot, right alongside the Chest.
- 7 The LORD's anger burned against Uzzah because of his irreverent act; therefore God struck him down and he died there beside the ark of God.
- 8 Then David got angry because of GOD's deadly outburst against Uzzah. That place is still called Perez Uzzah (The-Explosion-Against-Uzzah).
- 8 Then David was angry because the LORD's wrath had broken out against Uzzah, and to this day that place is called Perez Uzzah.
- 9 David became fearful of GOD that day and said, "This Chest is too hot to handle. How can I ever get it back to the City of David?"
- 9 David was afraid of the LORD that day and said, "How can the ark of the LORD ever come to me?"
- 10 He refused to take the Chest of GOD a step farther. Instead, David removed it off the road and to the house of Obed-Edom the Gittite.
- 10 He was not willing to take the ark of the LORD to be with him in the City of David. Instead, he took it aside to the house of Obed-Edom the Gittite.
- 11 The Chest of GOD stayed at the house of Obed-Edom the Gittite for three months. And GOD prospered Obed-Edom and his entire household.
- 11 The ark of the LORD remained in the house of Obed-Edom the Gittite for three months, and the LORD blessed him and his entire household.
- 12 It was reported to King David that GOD had prospered Obed-Edom and his entire household because of the Chest of God. So David thought, "I'll get that blessing for myself," and went and brought up the Chest of God from the house of Obed-Edom to the City of David, celebrating
- 12 Now King David was told, "The LORD has blessed the household of Obed-Edom and everything he has, because of the ark of God." So

- David went down and brought up the ark of God from the house of Obed-Edom to the City of David with rejoicing.
- 13 extravagantly all the way, with frequent sacrifices of choice bulls.
- 13 When those who were carrying the ark of the LORD had taken six steps, he sacrificed a bull and a fattened calf.
- 14 David, ceremonially dressed in priest's linen, danced with great abandon before GOD.
- 14 David, wearing a linen ephod, danced before the LORD with all his might,
- 15 The whole country was with him as he accompanied the Chest of GOD with shouts and trumpet blasts.
- 15 while he and the entire house of Israel brought up the ark of the LORD with shouts and the sound of trumpets.
- 16 But as the Chest of GOD came into the City of David, Michal, Saul's daughter, happened to be looking out a window. When she saw King David leaping and dancing before GOD, her heart filled with scorn.
- 16 As the ark of the LORD was entering the City of David, Michal daughter of Saul watched from a window. And when she saw King David leaping and dancing before the LORD, she despised him in her heart.
- 17 They brought the Chest of GOD and set it in the middle of the tent pavilion that David had pitched for it. Then and there David worshiped, offering burnt offerings and peace offerings.
- 17 They brought the ark of the LORD and set it in its place inside the tent that David had pitched for it, and David sacrificed burnt offerings and fellowship offerings before the LORD.
- 18 When David had completed the sacrifices of burnt and peace offerings, he blessed the people in the name of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies
- 18 After he had finished sacrificing the burnt offerings and fellowship offerings, he blessed the people in the name of the LORD Almighty.
- 19 and handed out to each person in the crowd, men and women alike, a loaf of bread, a date cake, and a raisin cake. Then everyone went home.
- 19 Then he gave a loaf of bread, a cake of dates and a cake of raisins to each person in the whole crowd of Israelites, both men and women. And all the people went to their homes.

- 20 David returned home to bless his family. Michal, Saul's daughter, came out to greet him: "How wonderfully the king has distinguished himself today--exposing himself to the eyes of the servants' maids like some burlesque street dancer!"
- 20 When David returned home to bless his household, Michal daughter of Saul came out to meet him and said, "How the king of Israel has distinguished himself today, disrobing in the sight of the slave girls of his servants as any vulgar fellow would!"
- 21 David replied to Michal, "In GOD's presence I'll dance all I want! He chose me over your father and the rest of our family and made me prince over GOD's people, over Israel. Oh yes, I'll dance to GOD's glory--
- 21 David said to Michal, "It was before the LORD, who chose me rather than your father or anyone from his house when he appointed me ruler over the LORD's people Israel--I will celebrate before the LORD.
- 22 more recklessly even than this. And as far as I'm concerned . . . I'll gladly look like a fool . . . but among these maids you're so worried about, I'll be honored no end."
- 22 I will become even more undignified than this, and I will be humiliated in my own eyes. But by these slave girls you spoke of, I will be held in honor."
- 23 Michal, Saul's daughter, was barren the rest of her life.
- 23 And Michal daughter of Saul had no children to the day of her death.

2 Samuel 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 Before long, the king made himself at home and GOD gave him peace from all his enemies.
- 1 After the king was settled in his palace and the LORD had given him rest from all his enemies around him,
- 2 Then one day King David said to Nathan the prophet, "Look at this: Here I am, comfortable in a luxurious house of cedar, and the Chest of God sits in a plain tent."
- 2 he said to Nathan the prophet, "Here I am, living in a palace of cedar, while the ark of God remains in a tent."

- 3 Nathan told the king, "Whatever is on your heart, go and do it. GOD is with you."
- 3 Nathan replied to the king, "Whatever you have in mind, go ahead and do it, for the LORD is with you."
- 4 But that night, the word of GOD came to Nathan saying,
- 4 That night the word of the LORD came to Nathan, saying:
- 5 "Go and tell my servant David: This is GOD's word on the matter: You're going to build a 'house' for me to live in?
- 5 Go and tell my servant David, 'This is what the LORD says: Are you the one to build me a house to dwell in?
- 6 Why, I haven't lived in a 'house' from the time I brought the children of Israel up from Egypt till now. All that time I've moved about with nothing but a tent.
- 6 I have not dwelt in a house from the day I brought the Israelites up out of Egypt to this day. I have been moving from place to place with a tent as my dwelling.
- 7 And in all my travels with Israel, did I ever say to any of the leaders I commanded to shepherd Israel, 'Why haven't you built me a house of cedar?'
- 7 Wherever I have moved with all the Israelites, did I ever say to any of their rulers whom I commanded to shepherd my people Israel, "Why have you not built me a house of cedar?" ' '
- 8 "So here is what you are to tell my servant David: The GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies has this word for you: I took you from the pasture, tagging along after sheep, and made you prince over my people Israel.
- 8 Now then, tell my servant David, 'This is what the LORD Almighty says: I took you from the pasture and from following the flock to be ruler over my people Israel.
- 9 I was with you everywhere you went and mowed your enemies down before you. Now I'm making you famous, to be ranked with the great names on earth.
- 9 I have been with you wherever you have gone, and I have cut off all your enemies from before you. Now I will make your name great, like the names of the greatest men of the earth.
- 10 And I'm going to set aside a place for my people Israel and plant them there so they'll have their own home and not be knocked around any

- more. Nor will evil men afflict you as they always have,
- 10 And I will provide a place for my people Israel and will plant them so that they can have a home of their own and no longer be disturbed. Wicked people will not oppress them anymore, as they did at the beginning
- 11 even during the days I set judges over my people Israel. Finally, I'm going to give you peace from all your enemies. "Furthermore, GOD has this message for you: GOD himself will build you a house!
- 11 and have done ever since the time I appointed leaders over my people Israel. I will also give you rest from all your enemies. " 'The LORD declares to you that the LORD himself will establish a house for you:
- 12 When your life is complete and you're buried with your ancestors, then I'll raise up your child, your own flesh and blood, to succeed you, and I'll firmly establish his rule.
- 12 When your days are over and you rest with your fathers, I will raise up your offspring to succeed you, who will come from your own body, and I will establish his kingdom.
- 13 He will build a house to honor me, and I will guarantee his kingdom's rule permanently.
- 13 He is the one who will build a house for my Name, and I will establish the throne of his kingdom forever.
- 14 I'll be a father to him, and he'll be a son to me. When he does wrong, I'll discipline him in the usual ways, the pitfalls and obstacles of this mortal life.
- 14 I will be his father, and he will be my son. When he does wrong, I will punish him with the rod of men, with floggings inflicted by men.
- 15 But I'll never remove my gracious love from him, as I removed it from Saul, who preceded you and whom I most certainly did remove.
- 15 But my love will never be taken away from him, as I took it away from Saul, whom I removed from before you.
- 16 Your family and your kingdom are permanently secured. I'm keeping my eye on them! And your royal throne will always be there, rock solid."
- 16 Your house and your kingdom will endure forever before me; your throne will be established forever.' "
- 17 Nathan gave David a complete and accurate account of everything he heard and saw in the vision.

- 17 Nathan reported to David all the words of this entire revelation.
- 18 King David went in, took his place before GOD, and prayed: "Who am I, my Master GOD, and what is my family, that you have brought me to this place in life?"
- 18 Then King David went in and sat before the LORD, and he said: "Who am I, O Sovereign LORD, and what is my family, that you have brought me this far?"
- 19 But that's nothing compared to what's coming, for you've also spoken of my family far into the future, given me a glimpse into tomorrow, my Master GOD!
- 19 And as if this were not enough in your sight, O Sovereign LORD, you have also spoken about the future of the house of your servant. Is this your usual way of dealing with man, O Sovereign LORD?
- 20 What can I possibly say in the face of all this? You know me, Master GOD, just as I am.
- 20 What more can David say to you? For you know your servant, O Sovereign LORD.
- 21 You've done all this not because of who I am but because of who you are--out of your very heart!--but you've let me in on it.
- 21 For the sake of your word and according to your will, you have done this great thing and made it known to your servant.
- 22 "This is what makes you so great, Master GOD! There is none like you, no God but you, nothing to compare with what we've heard with our own ears.
- 22 How great you are, O Sovereign LORD! There is no one like you, and there is no God but you, as we have heard with our own ears.
- 23 And who is like your people, like Israel, a nation unique in the earth, whom God set out to redeem for himself (and became most famous for it), performing great and fearsome acts, throwing out nations and their gods left and right as you saved your people from Egypt?
- 23 And who is like your people Israel--the one nation on earth that God went out to redeem as a people for himself, and to make a name for himself, and to perform great and awesome wonders by driving out nations and their gods from before your people, whom you redeemed from Egypt?

- 24 You established for yourself a people--your very own Israel!--your people permanently. And you, GOD, became their God.
- 24 You have established your people Israel as your very own forever, and you, O LORD, have become their God.
- 25 "So now, great GOD, this word that you have spoken to me and my family, guarantee it permanently! Do exactly what you've promised!
- 25 And now, LORD God, keep forever the promise you have made concerning your servant and his house. Do as you promised,
- 26 Then your reputation will flourish always as people exclaim, 'The GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies is God over Israel!' And the house of your servant David will remain sure and solid in your watchful presence.
- 26 so that your name will be great forever. Then men will say, 'The LORD Almighty is God over Israel!' And the house of your servant David will be established before you.
- 27 For you, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, Israel's God, told me plainly, 'I will build you a house.' That's how I was able to find the courage to pray this prayer to you.
- 27 O LORD Almighty, God of Israel, you have revealed this to your servant, saying, 'I will build a house for you.' So your servant has found courage to offer you this prayer.
- 28 "And now, Master GOD, being the God you are, speaking sure words as you do, and having just said this wonderful thing to me,
- 28 O Sovereign LORD, you are God! Your words are trustworthy, and you have promised these good things to your servant.
- 29 please, just one more thing: Bless my family; keep your eye on them always. You've already as much as said that you would, Master GOD! Oh, may your blessing be on my family permanently!"
- 29 Now be pleased to bless the house of your servant, that it may continue forever in your sight; for you, O Sovereign LORD, have spoken, and with your blessing the house of your servant will be blessed forever."

2 Samuel 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the days that followed, David struck hard at the Philistines--brought them to their knees and took control of the countryside.
- 1 In the course of time, David defeated the Philistines and subdued them, and he took Metheg Ammah from the control of the Philistines.
- 2 He also fought and defeated Moab. He chose two-thirds of them randomly and executed them. The other third he spared. So the Moabites fell under David's rule and were forced to bring tribute.
- 2 David also defeated the Moabites. He made them lie down on the ground and measured them off with a length of cord. Every two lengths of them were put to death, and the third length was allowed to live. So the Moabites became subject to David and brought tribute.
- 3 On his way to restore his sovereignty at the River Euphrates, David next defeated Hadadezer son of Rehob the king of Zobah.
- 3 Moreover, David fought Hadadezer son of Rehob, king of Zobah, when he went to restore his control along the Euphrates River.
- 4 He captured from him a thousand chariots, seven thousand cavalry, and twenty thousand infantry. He hamstringed all the chariot horses, but saved back a hundred.
- 4 David captured a thousand of his chariots, seven thousand charioteers and twenty thousand foot soldiers. He hamstringed all but a hundred of the chariot horses.
- 5 When the Arameans from Damascus came to the aid of Hadadezer king of Zobah, David killed twenty-two thousand of them.
- 5 When the Arameans of Damascus came to help Hadadezer king of Zobah, David struck down twenty-two thousand of them.
- 6 David set up a puppet government in Aram-Damascus. The Arameans became subjects of David and were forced to bring tribute. GOD gave victory to David wherever he marched.
- 6 He put garrisons in the Aramean kingdom of Damascus, and the Arameans became subject to him and brought tribute. The LORD gave David victory wherever he went.
- 7 David plundered the gold shields that belonged to the servants of Hadadezer and brought them to Jerusalem.
- 7 David took the gold shields that belonged to the officers of Hadadezer and brought them to Jerusalem.

- 8 He also looted a great quantity of bronze from Tebah and Berothai, cities of Hadadezer.
- 8 From Tebah and Berothai, towns that belonged to Hadadezer, King David took a great quantity of bronze.
- 9 Toi, king of Hamath, heard that David had struck down the entire army of Hadadezer.
- 9 When Tou king of Hamath heard that David had defeated the entire army of Hadadezer,
- 10 So he sent his son Joram to King David to greet and congratulate him for fighting and defeating them, for Toi and Hadadezer were old enemies. He brought with him gifts of silver, gold, and bronze.
- 10 he sent his son Joram to King David to greet him and congratulate him on his victory in battle over Hadadezer, who had been at war with Tou. Joram brought with him articles of silver and gold and bronze.
- 11 King David consecrated these along with the silver and gold from all the nations he had conquered--
- 11 King David dedicated these articles to the LORD, as he had done with the silver and gold from all the nations he had subdued:
- 12 from Aram, Moab, the Ammonites, the Philistines, and from Amalek, along with the plunder from Hadadezer son of Rehob king of Zobah.
- 12 Edom and Moab, the Ammonites and the Philistines, and Amalek. He also dedicated the plunder taken from Hadadezer son of Rehob, king of Zobah.
- 13 David built a victory monument on his return from defeating the Arameans. Abishai son of Zeruiah fought and defeated the Edomites in the Salt Valley. Eighteen thousand of them were killed.
- 13 And David became famous after he returned from striking down eighteen thousand Edomites in the Valley of Salt.
- 14 David set up a puppet government in Edom, and the Edomites became subjects under David. GOD gave David victory wherever he marched.
- 14 He put garrisons throughout Edom, and all the Edomites became subject to David. The LORD gave David victory wherever he went.
- 15 Thus David ruled over all of Israel. He ruled well--fair and evenhanded in all his duties and relationships.
- 15 David reigned over all Israel, doing what was just and right for all his people.

- 16 Joab son of Zeruiah was head of the army; Jehoshaphat son of Ahilud was clerk;
- 16 Joab son of Zeruiah was over the army; Jehoshaphat son of Ahilud was recorder;
- 17 Zadok son of Ahitub and Ahimelech son of Abiathar were priests; Seraiah was secretary;
- 17 Zadok son of Ahitub and Ahimelech son of Abiathar were priests; Seraiah was secretary;
- 18 Benaiah son of Jehoiada was over the Kerethites and Pelethites; And David's sons were priests.
- 18 Benaiah son of Jehoiada was over the Kerethites and Pelethites; and David's sons were royal advisers.

2 Samuel 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 One day David asked, "Is there anyone left of Saul's family? If so, I'd like to show him some kindness in honor of Jonathan."
- 1 David asked, "Is there anyone still left of the house of Saul to whom I can show kindness for Jonathan's sake?"
- 2 It happened that a servant from Saul's household named Ziba was there. They called him into David's presence. The king asked him, "Are you Ziba?" "Yes sir," he replied.
- 2 Now there was a servant of Saul's household named Ziba. They called him to appear before David, and the king said to him, "Are you Ziba?" "Your servant," he replied.
- 3 The king asked, "Is there anyone left from the family of Saul to whom I can show some godly kindness?" Ziba told the king, "Yes, there is Jonathan's son, lame in both feet."
- 3 The king asked, "Is there no one still left of the house of Saul to whom I can show God's kindness?" Ziba answered the king, "There is still a son of Jonathan; he is crippled in both feet."
- 4 "Where is he?" "He's living at the home of Makir son of Ammiel in Lo Debar."

- 4 Where is he? the king asked. Ziba answered, "He is at the house of Makir son of Ammiel in Lo Debar."
- 5 King David didn't lose a minute. He sent and got him from the home of Makir son of Ammiel in Lo Debar.
- 5 So King David had him brought from Lo Debar, from the house of Makir son of Ammiel.
- 6 When Mephibosheth son of Jonathan (who was the son of Saul), came before David, he bowed deeply, abasing himself, honoring David. David spoke his name: "Mephibosheth." "Yes sir?"
- 6 When Mephibosheth son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, came to David, he bowed down to pay him honor. David said, "Mephibosheth!" "Your servant," he replied.
- 7 "Don't be frightened," said David. "I'd like to do something special for you in memory of your father Jonathan. To begin with, I'm returning to you all the properties of your grandfather Saul. Furthermore, from now on you'll take all your meals at my table."
- 7 Don't be afraid, David said to him, "for I will surely show you kindness for the sake of your father Jonathan. I will restore to you all the land that belonged to your grandfather Saul, and you will always eat at my table."
- 8 Shuffling and stammering, not looking him in the eye, Mephibosheth said, "Who am I that you pay attention to a stray dog like me?"
- 8 Mephibosheth bowed down and said, "What is your servant, that you should notice a dead dog like me?"
- 9 David then called in Ziba, Saul's right-hand man, and told him, "Everything that belonged to Saul and his family, I've handed over to your master's grandson.
- 9 Then the king summoned Ziba, Saul's servant, and said to him, "I have given your master's grandson everything that belonged to Saul and his family.
- 10 You and your sons and your servants will work his land and bring in the produce, provisions for your master's grandson. Mephibosheth himself, your master's grandson, from now on will take all his meals at my table." Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants.
- 10 You and your sons and your servants are to farm the land for him and bring in the crops, so that your master's grandson may be provided for.

- And Mephibosheth, grandson of your master, will always eat at my table." (Now Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants.)
- 11 "All that my master the king has ordered his servant," answered Ziba, "your servant will surely do." And Mephibosheth ate at David's table, just like one of the royal family.
- 11 Then Ziba said to the king, "Your servant will do whatever my lord the king commands his servant to do." So Mephibosheth ate at David's table like one of the king's sons.
- 12 Mephibosheth also had a small son named Mica. All who were part of Ziba's household were now the servants of Mephibosheth.
- 12 Mephibosheth had a young son named Mica, and all the members of Ziba's household were servants of Mephibosheth.
- 13 Mephibosheth lived in Jerusalem, taking all his meals at the king's table. He was lame in both feet.
- 13 And Mephibosheth lived in Jerusalem, because he always ate at the king's table, and he was crippled in both feet.

2 Samuel 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 Sometime after this, the king of the Ammonites died and Hanun, his son, succeeded him as king.
- 1 In the course of time, the king of the Ammonites died, and his son Hanun succeeded him as king.
- 2 David said, "I'd like to show some kindness to Hanun, the son of Nahash-treat him as well and as kindly as his father treated me." So David sent Hanun condolences regarding his father. But when David's servants got to the land of the Ammonites,
- 2 David thought, "I will show kindness to Hanun son of Nahash, just as his father showed kindness to me." So David sent a delegation to express his sympathy to Hanun concerning his father. When David's men came to the land of the Ammonites,
- 3 the Ammonite leaders warned Hanun, their head delegate, "Do you for a minute suppose that David is honoring your father by sending you

- comforters? Don't you think it's because he wants to snoop around the city and size it up that David has sent his emissaries to you?"
- 3 the Ammonite nobles said to Hanun their lord, "Do you think David is honoring your father by sending men to you to express sympathy? Hasn't David sent them to you to explore the city and spy it out and overthrow it?"
- 4 So Hanun seized David's men, shaved off half their beards, cut off their robes halfway up their buttocks, and sent them packing.
- 4 So Hanun seized David's men, shaved off half of each man's beard, cut off their garments in the middle at the buttocks, and sent them away.
- 5 When all this was reported to David, he sent someone to meet them, for they were seriously humiliated. The king told them, "Stay in Jericho until your beards grow out. Only then come back."
- 5 When David was told about this, he sent messengers to meet the men, for they were greatly humiliated. The king said, "Stay at Jericho till your beards have grown, and then come back."
- 6 When it dawned on the Ammonites that as far as David was concerned they stunk to high heaven, they hired Aramean soldiers from Beth-Rehob and Zobah--twenty thousand infantry--and a thousand men from the king of Maacah, and twelve thousand men from Tob.
- 6 When the Ammonites realized that they had become a stench in David's nostrils, they hired twenty thousand Aramean foot soldiers from Beth Rehob and Zobah, as well as the king of Maacah with a thousand men, and also twelve thousand men from Tob.
- 7 When David heard of this, he dispatched Joab with his strongest fighters in full force.
- 7 On hearing this, David sent Joab out with the entire army of fighting men.
- 8 The Ammonites marched out and arranged themselves in battle formation at the city gate. The Arameans of Zobah and Rehob and the men of Tob and Maacah took up a position out in the open fields.
- 8 The Ammonites came out and drew up in battle formation at the entrance to their city gate, while the Arameans of Zobah and Rehob and the men of Tob and Maacah were by themselves in the open country.

- 9 When Joab saw that he had two fronts to fight, before and behind, he took his pick of the best of Israel and deployed them to confront the Arameans.
- 9 Joab saw that there were battle lines in front of him and behind him; so he selected some of the best troops in Israel and deployed them against the Arameans.
- 10 The rest of the army he put under the command of Abishai, his brother, and deployed them to confront the Ammonites.
- 10 He put the rest of the men under the command of Abishai his brother and deployed them against the Ammonites.
- 11 Then he said, "If the Arameans are too much for me, you help me. And if the Ammonites prove too much for you, I'll come and help you.
- 11 Joab said, "If the Arameans are too strong for me, then you are to come to my rescue; but if the Ammonites are too strong for you, then I will come to rescue you.
- 12 Courage! We'll fight with might and main for our people and for the cities of our God. And GOD will do whatever he sees needs doing!"
- 12 Be strong and let us fight bravely for our people and the cities of our God. The LORD will do what is good in his sight."
- 13 But when Joab and his soldiers moved in to fight the Arameans, they ran off in full retreat.
- 13 Then Joab and the troops with him advanced to fight the Arameans, and they fled before him.
- 14 Then the Ammonites, seeing the Arameans run for dear life, took to their heels from Abishai and went into the city. So Joab left off fighting the Ammonites and returned to Jerusalem.
- 14 When the Ammonites saw that the Arameans were fleeing, they fled before Abishai and went inside the city. So Joab returned from fighting the Ammonites and came to Jerusalem.
- 15 When the Arameans saw how badly they'd been beaten by Israel, they picked up the pieces and regrouped.
- 15 After the Arameans saw that they had been routed by Israel, they regrouped.
- 16 Hadadezer sent for the Arameans who were across the River. They came to Helam. Shobach, commander of Hadadezer's army, led them.

- 16 Hadadezer had Arameans brought from beyond the River; they went to Helam, with Shobach the commander of Hadadezer's army leading them.
- 17 All this was reported to David. So David mustered Israel, crossed the Jordan, and came to Helam. The Arameans went into battle formation, ready for David, and the fight was on.
- 17 When David was told of this, he gathered all Israel, crossed the Jordan and went to Helam. The Arameans formed their battle lines to meet David and fought against him.
- 18 But the Arameans again scattered before Israel. David killed seven hundred chariot drivers and forty thousand cavalry. And he mortally wounded Shobach, the army commander, who died on the battlefield.
- 18 But they fled before Israel, and David killed seven hundred of their charioteers and forty thousand of their foot soldiers. He also struck down Shobach the commander of their army, and he died there.
- 19 When all the kings who were vassals of Hadadezer saw that they had been routed by Israel, they made peace and became Israel's vassals. The Arameans were afraid to help the Ammonites ever again.
- 19 When all the kings who were vassals of Hadadezer saw that they had been defeated by Israel, they made peace with the Israelites and became subject to them. So the Arameans were afraid to help the Ammonites anymore.

2 Samuel 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 When that time of year came around again, the anniversary of the Ammonite aggression, David dispatched Joab and his fighting men of Israel in full force to destroy the Ammonites for good. They laid siege to Rabbah, but David stayed in Jerusalem.
- 1 In the spring, at the time when kings go off to war, David sent Joab out with the king's men and the whole Israelite army. They destroyed the Ammonites and besieged Rabbah. But David remained in Jerusalem.
- 2 One late afternoon, David got up from taking his nap and was strolling on the roof of the palace. From his vantage point on the roof he saw a woman bathing. The woman was stunningly beautiful.

- 2 One evening David got up from his bed and walked around on the roof of the palace. From the roof he saw a woman bathing. The woman was very beautiful,
- 3 David sent to ask about her, and was told, "Isn't this Bathsheba, daughter of Eliam and wife of Uriah the Hittite?"
- 3 and David sent someone to find out about her. The man said, "Isn't this Bathsheba, the daughter of Eliam and the wife of Uriah the Hittite?"
- 4 David sent his agents to get her. After she arrived, he went to bed with her. (This occurred during the time of "purification" following her period.) Then she returned home.
- 4 Then David sent messengers to get her. She came to him, and he slept with her. (She had purified herself from her uncleanness.) Then she went back home.
- 5 Before long she realized she was pregnant. Later she sent word to David: "I'm pregnant."
- 5 The woman conceived and sent word to David, saying, "I am pregnant."
- 6 David then got in touch with Joab: "Send Uriah the Hittite to me." Joab sent him.
- 6 So David sent this word to Joab: "Send me Uriah the Hittite." And Joab sent him to David.
- 7 When he arrived, David asked him for news from the front--how things were going with Joab and the troops and with the fighting.
- 7 When Uriah came to him, David asked him how Joab was, how the soldiers were and how the war was going.
- 8 Then he said to Uriah, "Go home. Have a refreshing bath and a good night's rest." After Uriah left the palace, an informant of the king was sent after him.
- 8 Then David said to Uriah, "Go down to your house and wash your feet." So Uriah left the palace, and a gift from the king was sent after him.
- 9 But Uriah didn't go home. He slept that night at the palace entrance, along with the king's servants.
- 9 But Uriah slept at the entrance to the palace with all his master's servants and did not go down to his house.
- 10 David was told that Uriah had not gone home. He asked Uriah, "Didn't you just come off a hard trip? So why didn't you go home?"

- 10 When David was told, "Uriah did not go home," he asked him, "Haven't you just come from a distance? Why didn't you go home?"
- 11 Uriah replied to David, "The Chest is out there with the fighting men of Israel and Judah--in tents. My master Joab and his servants are roughing it out in the fields. So, how can I go home and eat and drink and enjoy my wife? On your life, I'll not do it!"
- 11 Uriah said to David, "The ark and Israel and Judah are staying in tents, and my master Joab and my lord's men are camped in the open fields. How could I go to my house to eat and drink and lie with my wife? As surely as you live, I will not do such a thing!"
- 12 "All right," said David, "have it your way. Stay for the day and I'll send you back tomorrow." So Uriah stayed in Jerusalem the rest of the day. The next day
- 12 Then David said to him, "Stay here one more day, and tomorrow I will send you back." So Uriah remained in Jerusalem that day and the next.
- 13 David invited him to eat and drink with him, and David got him drunk. But in the evening Uriah again went out and slept with his master's servants. He didn't go home.
- 13 At David's invitation, he ate and drank with him, and David made him drunk. But in the evening Uriah went out to sleep on his mat among his master's servants; he did not go home.
- 14 In the morning David wrote a letter to Joab and sent it with Uriah.
- 14 In the morning David wrote a letter to Joab and sent it with Uriah.
- 15 In the letter he wrote, "Put Uriah in the front lines where the fighting is the fiercest. Then pull back and leave him exposed so that he's sure to be killed."
- 15 In it he wrote, "Put Uriah in the front line where the fighting is fiercest. Then withdraw from him so he will be struck down and die."
- 16 So Joab, holding the city under siege, put Uriah in a place where he knew there were fierce enemy fighters.
- 16 So while Joab had the city under siege, he put Uriah at a place where he knew the strongest defenders were.
- 17 When the city's defenders came out to fight Joab, some of David's soldiers were killed, including Uriah the Hittite.
- 17 When the men of the city came out and fought against Joab, some of the men in David's army fell; moreover, Uriah the Hittite died.

18 Joab sent David a full report on the battle.
18 Joab sent David a full account of the battle.
19 He instructed the messenger, "After you have given to the king a detailed report on the battle,
19 He instructed the messenger: "When you have finished giving the king this account of the battle,
20 if he flares in anger,
20 the king's anger may flare up, and he may ask you, 'Why did you get so close to the city to fight? Didn't you know they would shoot arrows from the wall?
21 say, 'And by the way, your servant Uriah the Hittite is dead.'"
21 Who killed Abimelech son of Jerub-Besheth? Didn't a woman throw an upper millstone on him from the wall, so that he died in Thebez? Why did you get so close to the wall?' If he asks you this, then say to him, 'Also, your servant Uriah the Hittite is dead.' "
22 Joab's messenger arrived in Jerusalem and gave the king a full report.
22 The messenger set out, and when he arrived he told David everything Joab had sent him to say.
23 He said, "The enemy was too much for us. They advanced on us in the open field, and we pushed them back to the city gate.
23 The messenger said to David, "The men overpowered us and came out against us in the open, but we drove them back to the entrance to the city gate.
24 But then arrows came hot and heavy on us from the city wall, and eighteen of the king's soldiers died."
24 Then the archers shot arrows at your servants from the wall, and some of the king's men died. Moreover, your servant Uriah the Hittite is dead."
25 When the messenger completed his report of the battle, David got angry at Joab. He vented it on the messenger: "Why did you get so close to the city? Didn't you know you'd be attacked from the wall? Didn't you remember how Abimelech son of Jerub-Besheth got killed? Wasn't it a woman who dropped a millstone on him from the wall and crushed him at Thebez? Why did you go close to the wall!" "By the way," said Joab's messenger, "your servant Uriah the Hittite is dead." Then David told the messenger, "Oh. I see. Tell Joab, 'Don't trouble yourself over this. War

- kills--sometimes one, sometimes another--you never know who's next. Redouble your assault on the city and destroy it.' Encourage Joab."
- 25 David told the messenger, "Say this to Joab: 'Don't let this upset you; the sword devours one as well as another. Press the attack against the city and destroy it.' Say this to encourage Joab."
- 26 When Uriah's wife heard that her husband was dead, she grieved for her husband.
- 26 When Uriah's wife heard that her husband was dead, she mourned for him.
- 27 When the time of mourning was over, David sent someone to bring her to his house. She became his wife and bore him a son.
- 27 After the time of mourning was over, David had her brought to his house, and she became his wife and bore him a son. But the thing David had done displeased the LORD.

2 Samuel 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 But GOD was not at all pleased with what David had done, and sent Nathan to David. Nathan said to him, "There were two men in the same city--one rich, the other poor.
- 1 The LORD sent Nathan to David. When he came to him, he said, "There were two men in a certain town, one rich and the other poor.
- 2 The rich man had huge flocks of sheep, herds of cattle.
- 2 The rich man had a very large number of sheep and cattle,
- 3 The poor man had nothing but one little female lamb, which he had bought and raised. It grew up with him and his children as a member of the family. It ate off his plate and drank from his cup and slept on his bed. It was like a daughter to him.
- 3 but the poor man had nothing except one little ewe lamb he had bought. He raised it, and it grew up with him and his children. It shared his food, drank from his cup and even slept in his arms. It was like a daughter to him.
- 4 "One day a traveler dropped in on the rich man. He was too stingy to take an animal from his own herds or flocks to make a meal for his visitor, so

- he took the poor man's lamb and prepared a meal to set before his guest."
- 4 Now a traveler came to the rich man, but the rich man refrained from taking one of his own sheep or cattle to prepare a meal for the traveler who had come to him. Instead, he took the ewe lamb that belonged to the poor man and prepared it for the one who had come to him.
- 5 David exploded in anger. "As surely as GOD lives," he said to Nathan, "the man who did this ought to be lynched!"
- 5 David burned with anger against the man and said to Nathan, "As surely as the LORD lives, the man who did this deserves to die!"
- 6 He must repay for the lamb four times over for his crime and his stinginess!"
- 6 He must pay for that lamb four times over, because he did such a thing and had no pity."
- 7 "You're the man!" said Nathan. "And here's what GOD, the God of Israel, has to say to you: I made you king over Israel. I freed you from the fist of Saul.
- 7 Then Nathan said to David, "You are the man! This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'I anointed you king over Israel, and I delivered you from the hand of Saul.
- 8 I gave you your master's daughter and other wives to have and to hold. I gave you both Israel and Judah. And if that hadn't been enough, I'd have gladly thrown in much more.
- 8 I gave your master's house to you, and your master's wives into your arms. I gave you the house of Israel and Judah. And if all this had been too little, I would have given you even more.
- 9 So why have you treated the word of GOD with brazen contempt, doing this great evil? You murdered Uriah the Hittite, then took his wife as your wife. Worse, you killed him with an Ammonite sword!
- 9 Why did you despise the word of the LORD by doing what is evil in his eyes? You struck down Uriah the Hittite with the sword and took his wife to be your own. You killed him with the sword of the Ammonites.
- 10 And now, because you treated God with such contempt and took Uriah the Hittite's wife as your wife, killing and murder will continually plague your family.
- 10 Now, therefore, the sword will never depart from your house, because you despised me and took the wife of Uriah the Hittite to be your own.'

- 11 This is GOD speaking, remember! I'll make trouble for you out of your own family. I'll take your wives from right out in front of you. I'll give them to some neighbor, and he'll go to bed with them openly.
- 11 This is what the LORD says: 'Out of your own household I am going to bring calamity upon you. Before your very eyes I will take your wives and give them to one who is close to you, and he will lie with your wives in broad daylight.
- 12 You did your deed in secret; I'm doing mine with the whole country watching!"
- 12 You did it in secret, but I will do this thing in broad daylight before all Israel.' "
- 13 Then David confessed to Nathan, "I've sinned against GOD." Nathan pronounced, "Yes, but that's not the last word. GOD forgives your sin. You won't die for it.
- 13 Then David said to Nathan, "I have sinned against the LORD." Nathan replied, "The LORD has taken away your sin. You are not going to die.
- 14 But because of your blasphemous behavior, the son born to you will die."
- 14 But because by doing this you have made the enemies of the LORD show utter contempt, the son born to you will die."
- 15 After Nathan went home, GOD afflicted the child that Uriah's wife bore to David, and he came down sick.
- 15 After Nathan had gone home, the LORD struck the child that Uriah's wife had borne to David, and he became ill.
- 16 David prayed desperately to God for the little boy. He fasted, wouldn't go out, and slept on the floor.
- 16 David pleaded with God for the child. He fasted and went into his house and spent the nights lying on the ground.
- 17 The elders in his family came in and tried to get him off the floor, but he wouldn't budge. Nor could they get him to eat anything.
- 17 The elders of his household stood beside him to get him up from the ground, but he refused, and he would not eat any food with them.
- 18 On the seventh day the child died. David's servants were afraid to tell him. They said, "What do we do now? While the child was living he wouldn't listen to a word we said. Now, with the child dead, if we speak to him there's no telling what he'll do."

- 18 On the seventh day the child died. David's servants were afraid to tell him that the child was dead, for they thought, "While the child was still living, we spoke to David but he would not listen to us. How can we tell him the child is dead? He may do something desperate."
- 19 David noticed that the servants were whispering behind his back, and realized that the boy must have died. He asked the servants, "Is the boy dead?" "Yes," they answered. "He's dead."
- 19 David noticed that his servants were whispering among themselves and he realized the child was dead. "Is the child dead?" he asked. "Yes," they replied, "he is dead."
- 20 David got up from the floor, washed his face and combed his hair, put on a fresh change of clothes, then went into the sanctuary and worshiped. Then he came home and asked for something to eat. They set it before him and he ate.
- 20 Then David got up from the ground. After he had washed, put on lotions and changed his clothes, he went into the house of the LORD and worshiped. Then he went to his own house, and at his request they served him food, and he ate.
- 21 His servants asked him, "What's going on with you? While the child was alive you fasted and wept and stayed up all night. Now that he's dead, you get up and eat."
- 21 His servants asked him, "Why are you acting this way? While the child was alive, you fasted and wept, but now that the child is dead, you get up and eat!"
- 22 "While the child was alive," he said, "I fasted and wept, thinking GOD might have mercy on me and the child would live.
- 22 He answered, "While the child was still alive, I fasted and wept. I thought, 'Who knows? The LORD may be gracious to me and let the child live.'
- 23 But now that he's dead, why fast? Can I bring him back now? I can go to him, but he can't come to me."
- 23 But now that he is dead, why should I fast? Can I bring him back again? I will go to him, but he will not return to me."
- 24 David went and comforted his wife Bathsheba. And when he slept with her, they conceived a son. When he was born they named him Solomon. GOD had a special love for him

24 Then David comforted his wife Bathsheba, and he went to her and lay with her. She gave birth to a son, and they named him Solomon. The LORD loved him;

25 and sent word by Nathan the prophet that GOD wanted him named Jedidiah (God's Beloved).

25 and because the LORD loved him, he sent word through Nathan the prophet to name him Jedidiah.

26 Joab, at war in Rabbah against the Ammonites, captured the royal city.

26 Meanwhile Joab fought against Rabbah of the Ammonites and captured the royal citadel.

27 He sent messengers to David saying, "I'm fighting at Rabbah, and I've just captured the city's water supply.

27 Joab then sent messengers to David, saying, "I have fought against Rabbah and taken its water supply.

28 Hurry and get the rest of the troops together and set up camp here at the city and complete the capture yourself. Otherwise, I'll capture it and get all the credit instead of you."

28 Now muster the rest of the troops and besiege the city and capture it. Otherwise I will take the city, and it will be named after me."

29 So David marshaled all the troops, went to Rabbah, and fought and captured it.

29 So David mustered the entire army and went to Rabbah, and attacked and captured it.

30 He took the crown from their king's head--very heavy with gold, and with a precious stone in it. It ended up on David's head. And they plundered the city, carrying off a great quantity of loot.

30 He took the crown from the head of their king--its weight was a talent of gold, and it was set with precious stones--and it was placed on David's head. He took a great quantity of plunder from the city

31 David emptied the city of its people and put them to slave labor using saws, picks, and axes, and making bricks. He did this to all the Ammonite cities. Then David and the whole army returned to Jerusalem.

31 and brought out the people who were there, consigning them to labor with saws and with iron picks and axes, and he made them work at brickmaking. He did this to all the Ammonite towns. Then David and his entire army returned to Jerusalem.

2 Samuel 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 Some time later, this happened: Absalom, David's son, had a sister who was very attractive. Her name was Tamar. Amnon, also David's son, was in love with her.
- 1 In the course of time, Amnon son of David fell in love with Tamar, the beautiful sister of Absalom son of David.
- 2 Amnon was obsessed with his sister Tamar to the point of making himself sick over her. She was a virgin, so he couldn't see how he could get his hands on her.
- 2 Amnon became frustrated to the point of illness on account of his sister Tamar, for she was a virgin, and it seemed impossible for him to do anything to her.
- 3 Amnon had a good friend, Jonadab, the son of David's brother Shimeah. Jonadab was exceptionally streetwise.
- 3 Now Amnon had a friend named Jonadab son of Shimeah, David's brother. Jonadab was a very shrewd man.
- 4 He said to Amnon, "Why are you moping around like this, day after day--you, the son of the king! Tell me what's eating at you." "In a word, Tamar," said Amnon. "My brother Absalom's sister. I'm in love with her."
- 4 He asked Amnon, "Why do you, the king's son, look so haggard morning after morning? Won't you tell me?" Amnon said to him, "I'm in love with Tamar, my brother Absalom's sister."
- 5 "Here's what you do," said Jonadab. "Go to bed and pretend you're sick. When your father comes to visit you, say, 'Have my sister Tamar come and prepare some supper for me here where I can watch her and she can feed me.'"
- 5 Go to bed and pretend to be ill, Jonadab said. "When your father comes to see you, say to him, 'I would like my sister Tamar to come and give me something to eat. Let her prepare the food in my sight so I may watch her and then eat it from her hand.' "

- 6 So Amnon took to his bed and acted sick. When the king came to visit, Amnon said, "Would you do me a favor? Have my sister Tamar come and make some nourishing dumplings here where I can watch her and be fed by her."
- 6 So Amnon lay down and pretended to be ill. When the king came to see him, Amnon said to him, "I would like my sister Tamar to come and make some special bread in my sight, so I may eat from her hand."
- 7 David sent word to Tamar who was home at the time: "Go to the house of your brother Amnon and prepare a meal for him."
- 7 David sent word to Tamar at the palace: "Go to the house of your brother Amnon and prepare some food for him."
- 8 So Tamar went to her brother Amnon's house. She took dough, kneaded it, formed it into dumplings, and cooked them while he watched from his bed.
- 8 So Tamar went to the house of her brother Amnon, who was lying down. She took some dough, kneaded it, made the bread in his sight and baked it.
- 9 But when she took the cooking pot and served him, he wouldn't eat. Amnon said, "Clear everyone out of the house," and they all cleared out.
- 9 Then she took the pan and served him the bread, but he refused to eat. "Send everyone out of here," Amnon said. So everyone left him.
- 10 Then he said to Tamar, "Bring the food into my bedroom, where we can eat in privacy." She took the nourishing dumplings she had prepared and brought them to her brother Amnon in his bedroom.
- 10 Then Amnon said to Tamar, "Bring the food here into my bedroom so I may eat from your hand." And Tamar took the bread she had prepared and brought it to her brother Amnon in his bedroom.
- 11 But when she got ready to feed him, he grabbed her and said, "Come to bed with me, sister!"
- 11 But when she took it to him to eat, he grabbed her and said, "Come to bed with me, my sister."
- 12 "No, brother!" she said, "Don't hurt me! This kind of thing isn't done in Israel! Don't do this terrible thing!"
- 12 Don't, my brother! she said to him. "Don't force me. Such a thing should not be done in Israel! Don't do this wicked thing."

- 13 Where could I ever show my face? And you--you'll be out on the street in disgrace. Oh, please! Speak to the king--he'll let you marry me."
- 13 What about me? Where could I get rid of my disgrace? And what about you? You would be like one of the wicked fools in Israel. Please speak to the king; he will not keep me from being married to you."
- 14 But he wouldn't listen. Being much stronger than she, he raped her.
- 14 But he refused to listen to her, and since he was stronger than she, he raped her.
- 15 No sooner had Amnon raped her than he hated her--an immense hatred. The hatred that he felt for her was greater than the love he'd had for her. "Get up," he said, "and get out!"
- 15 Then Amnon hated her with intense hatred. In fact, he hated her more than he had loved her. Amnon said to her, "Get up and get out!"
- 16 "Oh no, brother," she said. "Please! This is an even worse evil than what you just did to me!" But he wouldn't listen to her.
- 16 No! she said to him. "Sending me away would be a greater wrong than what you have already done to me." But he refused to listen to her.
- 17 He called for his valet. "Get rid of this woman. Get her out of my sight! And lock the door after her."
- 17 He called his personal servant and said, "Get this woman out of here and bolt the door after her."
- 18 The valet threw her out and locked the door behind her. She was wearing a long-sleeved gown. (That's how virgin princesses used to dress from early adolescence on.)
- 18 So his servant put her out and bolted the door after her. She was wearing a richly ornamented robe, for this was the kind of garment the virgin daughters of the king wore.
- 19 Tamar poured ashes on her head, then she ripped the long-sleeved gown, held her head in her hands, and walked away, sobbing as she went.
- 19 Tamar put ashes on her head and tore the ornamented robe she was wearing. She put her hand on her head and went away, weeping aloud as she went.
- 20 Her brother Absalom said to her, "Has your brother Amnon had his way with you? Now, my dear sister, let's keep it quiet--a family matter. He is,

after all, your brother. Don't take this so hard." Tamar lived in her brother Absalom's home, bitter and desolate.

20 Her brother Absalom said to her, "Has that Amnon, your brother, been with you? Be quiet now, my sister; he is your brother. Don't take this thing to heart." And Tamar lived in her brother Absalom's house, a desolate woman.

21 King David heard the whole story and was enraged,

21 When King David heard all this, he was furious.

22 but he didn't discipline Amnon. David doted on him because he was his firstborn. Absalom quit speaking to Amnon--not a word, whether good or bad--because he hated him for violating his sister Tamar.

22 Absalom never said a word to Amnon, either good or bad; he hated Amnon because he had disgraced his sister Tamar.

23 Two years went by. One day Absalom threw a sheep-shearing party in Baal Hazor in the vicinity of Ephraim and invited all the king's sons.

23 Two years later, when Absalom's sheepshearers were at Baal Hazor near the border of Ephraim, he invited all the king's sons to come there.

24 He also went to the king and invited him. "Look, I'm throwing a sheep-shearing party. Come, and bring your servants."

24 Absalom went to the king and said, "Your servant has had shearers come. Will the king and his officials please join me?"

25 But the king said, "No, son--not this time, and not the whole household. We'd just be a burden to you." Absalom pushed, but David wouldn't budge. But he did give him his blessing.

25 No, my son, the king replied. "All of us should not go; we would only be a burden to you." Although Absalom urged him, he still refused to go, but gave him his blessing.

26 Then Absalom said, "Well, if you won't come, at least let my brother Amnon come." "And why," said the king, "should he go with you?"

26 Then Absalom said, "If not, please let my brother Amnon come with us." The king asked him, "Why should he go with you?"

27 But Absalom was so insistent that he gave in and let Amnon and all the rest of the king's sons go.

27 But Absalom urged him, so he sent with him Amnon and the rest of the king's sons.

- 28 Absalom prepared a banquet fit for a king. Then he instructed his servants, "Look sharp, now. When Amnon is well into the sauce and feeling no pain, and I give the order 'Strike Amnon,' kill him. And don't be afraid--I'm the one giving the command. Courage! You can do it!"
- 28 Absalom ordered his men, "Listen! When Amnon is in high spirits from drinking wine and I say to you, 'Strike Amnon down,' then kill him. Don't be afraid. Have not I given you this order? Be strong and brave."
- 29 Absalom's servants did to Amnon exactly what their master ordered. All the king's sons got out as fast as they could, jumped on their mules, and rode off.
- 29 So Absalom's men did to Amnon what Absalom had ordered. Then all the king's sons got up, mounted their mules and fled.
- 30 While they were still on the road, a rumor came to the king: "Absalom just killed all the king's sons--not one is left!"
- 30 While they were on their way, the report came to David: "Absalom has struck down all the king's sons; not one of them is left."
- 31 The king stood up, ripped his clothes to shreds, and threw himself on the floor. All his servants who were standing around at the time did the same.
- 31 The king stood up, tore his clothes and lay down on the ground; and all his servants stood by with their clothes torn.
- 32 Just then, Jonadab, his brother Shimeah's son, stepped up. "My master must not think that all the young men, the king's sons, are dead. Only Amnon is dead. This happened because of Absalom's outrage since the day that Amnon violated his sister Tamar.
- 32 But Jonadab son of Shimeah, David's brother, said, "My lord should not think that they killed all the princes; only Amnon is dead. This has been Absalom's expressed intention ever since the day Amnon raped his sister Tamar.
- 33 So my master, the king, mustn't make things worse than they are, thinking that all your sons are dead. Only Amnon is dead."
- 33 My lord the king should not be concerned about the report that all the king's sons are dead. Only Amnon is dead."
- 34 Absalom fled. Just then the sentry on duty looked up and saw a cloud of dust on the road from Horonaim alongside the mountain. He came and

- told the king, "I've just seen a bunch of men on the Horonaim road, coming around the mountain."
- 34 Meanwhile, Absalom had fled. Now the man standing watch looked up and saw many people on the road west of him, coming down the side of the hill. The watchman went and told the king, "I see men in the direction of Horonaim, on the side of the hill."
- 35 Then Jonadab exclaimed to the king, "See! It's the king's sons coming, just as I said!"
- 35 Jonadab said to the king, "See, the king's sons are here; it has happened just as your servant said."
- 36 He had no sooner said the words than the king's sons burst in--loud laments and weeping! The king joined in, along with all the servants--loud weeping, many tears.
- 36 As he finished speaking, the king's sons came in, wailing loudly. The king, too, and all his servants wept very bitterly.
- 37 David mourned the death of his son a long time. When Absalom fled, he went to Talmai son of Ammihud, king of Geshur.
- 37 Absalom fled and went to Talmai son of Ammihud, the king of Geshur. But King David mourned for his son every day.
- 38 He was there three years.
- 38 After Absalom fled and went to Geshur, he stayed there three years.
- 39 The king finally gave up trying to get back at Absalom. He had come to terms with Amnon's death.
- 39 And the spirit of the king longed to go to Absalom, for he was consoled concerning Amnon's death.

2 Samuel 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 Joab son of Zeruiah knew that the king, deep down, still cared for Absalom.
- 1 Joab son of Zeruiah knew that the king's heart longed for Absalom.
- 2 So he sent to Tekoa for a wise woman who lived there and instructed her, "Pretend you are in mourning. Dress in black and don't comb your hair,

- so you'll look like you've been grieving over a dead loved one for a long time.
- 2 So Joab sent someone to Tekoa and had a wise woman brought from there. He said to her, "Pretend you are in mourning. Dress in mourning clothes, and don't use any cosmetic lotions. Act like a woman who has spent many days grieving for the dead.
- 3 Then go to the king and tell him this . . . " Joab then told her exactly what to say.
- 3 Then go to the king and speak these words to him." And Joab put the words in her mouth.
- 4 The woman of Tekoa went to the king, bowed deeply before him in homage, and said, "O King, help!"
- 4 When the woman from Tekoa went to the king, she fell with her face to the ground to pay him honor, and she said, "Help me, O king!"
- 5 He said, "How can I help?" "I'm a widow," she said. "My husband is dead.
- 5 The king asked her, "What is troubling you?" She said, "I am indeed a widow; my husband is dead.
- 6 I had two sons. The two of them got into a fight out in the field and there was no one around to step between them. The one struck the other and killed him.
- 6 I your servant had two sons. They got into a fight with each other in the field, and no one was there to separate them. One struck the other and killed him.
- 7 Then the whole family ganged up against me and demanded, 'Hand over this murderer so we can kill him for the life of the brother he murdered!' They want to wipe out the heir and snuff out the one spark of life left to me. And then there would be nothing left of my husband--not so much as a name--on the face of the earth.
- 7 Now the whole clan has risen up against your servant; they say, 'Hand over the one who struck his brother down, so that we may put him to death for the life of his brother whom he killed; then we will get rid of the heir as well.' They would put out the only burning coal I have left, leaving my husband neither name nor descendant on the face of the earth."
- 8 The king said, "Go home, and I'll take care of this for you."

- 8 The king said to the woman, "Go home, and I will issue an order in your behalf."
- 9 "I'll take all responsibility for what happens," the woman of Tekoa said. "I don't want to compromise the king and his reputation."
- 9 But the woman from Tekoa said to him, "My lord the king, let the blame rest on me and on my father's family, and let the king and his throne be without guilt."
- 10 "Bring the man who has been harassing you," the king continued. "I'll see to it that he doesn't bother you anymore."
- 10 The king replied, "If anyone says anything to you, bring him to me, and he will not bother you again."
- 11 "Let the king invoke the name of GOD," said the woman, "so this self-styled vigilante won't ruin everything, to say nothing of killing my son." "As surely as GOD lives," he said, "not so much as a hair of your son's head will be lost."
- 11 She said, "Then let the king invoke the LORD his God to prevent the avenger of blood from adding to the destruction, so that my son will not be destroyed." "As surely as the LORD lives," he said, "not one hair of your son's head will fall to the ground."
- 12 Then she asked, "May I say one more thing to my master, the king?" He said, "Go ahead."
- 12 Then the woman said, "Let your servant speak a word to my lord the king." "Speak," he replied.
- 13 "Why, then," the woman said, "have you done this very thing against God's people? In his verdict, the king convicts himself by not bringing home his exiled son."
- 13 The woman said, "Why then have you devised a thing like this against the people of God? When the king says this, does he not convict himself, for the king has not brought back his banished son?"
- 14 We all die sometime. Water spilled on the ground can't be gathered up again. But God does not take away life. He works out ways to get the exile back."
- 14 Like water spilled on the ground, which cannot be recovered, so we must die. But God does not take away life; instead, he devises ways so that a banished person may not remain estranged from him.

- 15 "So now I've dared come to the king, my master, about all this. They're making my life miserable, and I'm afraid. I said to myself, 'I'll go to the king. Maybe he'll do something!'
- 15 And now I have come to say this to my lord the king because the people have made me afraid. Your servant thought, 'I will speak to the king; perhaps he will do what his servant asks.'
- 16 When the king hears what's going on, he'll step in and rescue me from the abuse of the man who would get rid of me and my son and God's inheritance--the works!'
- 16 Perhaps the king will agree to deliver his servant from the hand of the man who is trying to cut off both me and my son from the inheritance God gave us.'
- 17 As your handmaid, I decided ahead of time, 'The word of my master, the king, will be the last word in this, for my master is like an angel of God in discerning good and evil.' GOD be with you!"
- 17 And now your servant says, 'May the word of my lord the king bring me rest, for my lord the king is like an angel of God in discerning good and evil. May the LORD your God be with you.'
- 18 The king then said, "I'm going to ask you something. Answer me truthfully." "Certainly," she said. "Let my master, the king, speak."
- 18 Then the king said to the woman, "Do not keep from me the answer to what I am going to ask you." "Let my lord the king speak," the woman said.
- 19 The king said, "Is the hand of Joab mixed up in this?" "On your life, my master king, a body can't veer an inch right or left and get by with it in the royal presence! Yes, it was your servant Joab who put me up to this, and put these very words in my mouth."
- 19 The king asked, "Isn't the hand of Joab with you in all this?" The woman answered, "As surely as you live, my lord the king, no one can turn to the right or to the left from anything my lord the king says. Yes, it was your servant Joab who instructed me to do this and who put all these words into the mouth of your servant."
- 20 It was because he wanted to turn things around that your servant Joab did this. But my master is as wise as God's angels in knowing how to handle things on this earth."

- 20 Your servant Joab did this to change the present situation. My lord has wisdom like that of an angel of God--he knows everything that happens in the land."
- 21 The king spoke to Joab. "All right, I'll do it. Go and bring the young man Absalom back."
- 21 The king said to Joab, "Very well, I will do it. Go, bring back the young man Absalom."
- 22 Joab bowed deeply in reverence and blessed the king. "I'm reassured to know that I'm still in your good graces and have your confidence, since the king is taking the counsel of his servant."
- 22 Joab fell with his face to the ground to pay him honor, and he blessed the king. Joab said, "Today your servant knows that he has found favor in your eyes, my lord the king, because the king has granted his servant's request."
- 23 Joab got up, went to Geshur, and brought Absalom to Jerusalem.
- 23 Then Joab went to Geshur and brought Absalom back to Jerusalem.
- 24 The king said, "He may return to his house, but he is not to see me face to face." So Absalom returned home, but was not permitted to see the king.
- 24 But the king said, "He must go to his own house; he must not see my face." So Absalom went to his own house and did not see the face of the king.
- 25 This Absalom! There wasn't a man in all Israel talked about so much for his handsome good looks--and not a blemish on him from head to toe!
- 25 In all Israel there was not a man so highly praised for his handsome appearance as Absalom. From the top of his head to the sole of his foot there was no blemish in him.
- 26 When he cut his hair--he always cut it short in the spring because it had grown so heavy--the weight of the hair from his head was over two pounds!
- 26 Whenever he cut the hair of his head--he used to cut his hair from time to time when it became too heavy for him--he would weigh it, and its weight was two hundred shekels by the royal standard.
- 27 Three sons were born to Absalom, and one daughter. Her name was Tamar--and she was a beauty.

- 27 Three sons and a daughter were born to Absalom. The daughter's name was Tamar, and she became a beautiful woman.
- 28 Absalom lived in Jerusalem for two years, and not once did he see the king face to face.
- 28 Absalom lived two years in Jerusalem without seeing the king's face.
- 29 He sent for Joab to get him in to see the king, but Joab still wouldn't budge. He tried a second time and Joab still wouldn't.
- 29 Then Absalom sent for Joab in order to send him to the king, but Joab refused to come to him. So he sent a second time, but he refused to come.
- 30 So he told his servants, "Listen. Joab's field adjoins mine, and he has a crop of barley in it. Go set fire to it." So Absalom's servants set fire to the field.
- 30 Then he said to his servants, "Look, Joab's field is next to mine, and he has barley there. Go and set it on fire." So Absalom's servants set the field on fire.
- 31 That got him moving--Joab came to Absalom at home and said, "Why did your servants set my field on fire?"
- 31 Then Joab did go to Absalom's house and he said to him, "Why have your servants set my field on fire?"
- 32 Absalom answered him, "Listen, I sent for you saying, 'Come, and soon. I want to send you to the king to ask, "What's the point of my coming back from Geshur? I'd be better off still there!" Let me see the king face to face. If he finds me guilty, then he can put me to death.'"
- 32 Absalom said to Joab, "Look, I sent word to you and said, 'Come here so I can send you to the king to ask, "Why have I come from Geshur? It would be better for me if I were still there!" ' Now then, I want to see the king's face, and if I am guilty of anything, let him put me to death."
- 33 Joab went to the king and told him what was going on. Absalom was then summoned--he came and bowed deeply in reverence before him. And the king kissed Absalom.
- 33 So Joab went to the king and told him this. Then the king summoned Absalom, and he came in and bowed down with his face to the ground before the king. And the king kissed Absalom.

2 Samuel 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 As time went on, Absalom took to riding in a horse-drawn chariot, with fifty men running in front of him.
- 1 In the course of time, Absalom provided himself with a chariot and horses and with fifty men to run ahead of him.
- 2 Early each morning he would take up his post beside the road at the city gate. When anyone showed up with a case to bring to the king for a decision, Absalom would call him over and say, "Where do you hail from?" And the answer would come, "Your servant is from one of the tribes of Israel."
- 2 He would get up early and stand by the side of the road leading to the city gate. Whenever anyone came with a complaint to be placed before the king for a decision, Absalom would call out to him, "What town are you from?" He would answer, "Your servant is from one of the tribes of Israel."
- 3 Then Absalom would say, "Look, you've got a strong case; but the king isn't going to listen to you."
- 3 Then Absalom would say to him, "Look, your claims are valid and proper, but there is no representative of the king to hear you."
- 4 Then he'd say, "Why doesn't someone make me a judge for this country? Anybody with a case could bring it to me and I'd settle things fair and square."
- 4 And Absalom would add, "If only I were appointed judge in the land! Then everyone who has a complaint or case could come to me and I would see that he gets justice."
- 5 Whenever someone would treat him with special honor, he'd shrug it off and treat him like an equal, making him feel important.
- 5 Also, whenever anyone approached him to bow down before him, Absalom would reach out his hand, take hold of him and kiss him.
- 6 Absalom did this to everyone who came to do business with the king and stole the hearts of everyone in Israel.
- 6 Absalom behaved in this way toward all the Israelites who came to the king asking for justice, and so he stole the hearts of the men of Israel.

- 7 After four years of this, Absalom spoke to the king, "Let me go to Hebron to pay a vow that I made to GOD.
- 7 At the end of four years, Absalom said to the king, "Let me go to Hebron and fulfill a vow I made to the LORD.
- 8 Your servant made a vow when I was living in Geshur in Aram saying, 'If GOD will bring me back to Jerusalem, I'll serve him with my life.'
- 8 While your servant was living at Geshur in Aram, I made this vow: 'If the LORD takes me back to Jerusalem, I will worship the LORD in Hebron.'
- 9 The king said, "Go with my blessing." And he got up and set off for Hebron.
- 9 The king said to him, "Go in peace." So he went to Hebron.
- 10 Then Absalom sent undercover agents to all the tribes of Israel with the message, "When you hear the blast of the ram's horn trumpet, that's your signal: Shout, 'Absalom is king in Hebron!'"
- 10 Then Absalom sent secret messengers throughout the tribes of Israel to say, "As soon as you hear the sound of the trumpets, then say, 'Absalom is king in Hebron.' "
- 11 Two hundred men went with Absalom from Jerusalem. But they had been called together knowing nothing of the plot and made the trip innocently.
- 11 Two hundred men from Jerusalem had accompanied Absalom. They had been invited as guests and went quite innocently, knowing nothing about the matter.
- 12 While Absalom was offering sacrifices, he managed also to involve Ahithophel the Gilonite, David's advisor, calling him away from his hometown of Giloh. The conspiracy grew powerful and Absalom's supporters multiplied.
- 12 While Absalom was offering sacrifices, he also sent for Ahithophel the Gilonite, David's counselor, to come from Giloh, his hometown. And so the conspiracy gained strength, and Absalom's following kept on increasing.
- 13 Someone came to David with the report, "The whole country has taken up with Absalom!"
- 13 A messenger came and told David, "The hearts of the men of Israel are with Absalom."

- 14 "Up and out of here!" called David to all his servants who were with him in Jerusalem. "We've got to run for our lives or none of us will escape Absalom! Hurry, he's about to pull the city down around our ears and slaughter us all!"
- 14 Then David said to all his officials who were with him in Jerusalem, "Come! We must flee, or none of us will escape from Absalom. We must leave immediately, or he will move quickly to overtake us and bring ruin upon us and put the city to the sword."
- 15 The king's servants said, "Whatever our master, the king, says, we'll do; we're with you all the way!"
- 15 The king's officials answered him, "Your servants are ready to do whatever our lord the king chooses."
- 16 So the king and his entire household escaped on foot. The king left ten concubines behind to tend to the palace.
- 16 The king set out, with his entire household following him; but he left ten concubines to take care of the palace.
- 17 And so they left, step by step by step, and then paused at the last house
- 17 So the king set out, with all the people following him, and they halted at a place some distance away.
- 18 as the whole army passed by him--all the Kerethites, all the Pelethites, and the six hundred Gittites who had marched with him from Gath, went past.
- 18 All his men marched past him, along with all the Kerethites and Pelethites; and all the six hundred Gittites who had accompanied him from Gath marched before the king.
- 19 The king called out to Ittai the Gittite, "What are you doing here? Go back with King Absalom. You're a stranger here and freshly uprooted from your own country.
- 19 The king said to Ittai the Gittite, "Why should you come along with us? Go back and stay with King Absalom. You are a foreigner, an exile from your homeland.
- 20 You arrived only yesterday, and am I going to let you take your chances with us as I live on the road like a gypsy? Go back, and take your family with you. And God's grace and truth go with you!"
- 20 You came only yesterday. And today shall I make you wander about with us, when I do not know where I am going? Go back, and take your

countrymen. May kindness and faithfulness be with you."

21 But Ittai answered, "As GOD lives and my master the king lives, where my master is, that's where I'll be--whether it means life or death."

21 But Ittai replied to the king, "As surely as the LORD lives, and as my lord the king lives, wherever my lord the king may be, whether it means life or death, there will your servant be."

22 "All right," said David, "go ahead." And they went on, Ittai the Gittite with all his men and all the children he had with him.

22 David said to Ittai, "Go ahead, march on." So Ittai the Gittite marched on with all his men and the families that were with him.

23 The whole country was weeping in loud lament as all the people passed by. As the king crossed the Brook Kidron, the army headed for the road to the wilderness.

23 The whole countryside wept aloud as all the people passed by. The king also crossed the Kidron Valley, and all the people moved on toward the desert.

24 Zadok was also there, the Levites with him, carrying GOD's Chest of the Covenant. They set the Chest of God down, Abiathar standing by, until all the people had evacuated the city.

24 Zadok was there, too, and all the Levites who were with him were carrying the ark of the covenant of God. They set down the ark of God, and Abiathar offered sacrifices until all the people had finished leaving the city.

25 Then the king ordered Zadok, "Take the Chest back to the city. If I get back in GOD's good graces, he'll bring me back and show me where the Chest has been set down.

25 Then the king said to Zadok, "Take the ark of God back into the city. If I find favor in the LORD's eyes, he will bring me back and let me see it and his dwelling place again.

26 But if he says, 'I'm not pleased with you'--well, he can then do with me whatever he pleases."

26 But if he says, 'I am not pleased with you,' then I am ready; let him do to me whatever seems good to him."

27 The king directed Zadok the priest, "Here's the plan: Return to the city peacefully, with Ahimaaz your son and Jonathan, Abiathar's son, with you.

- 27 The king also said to Zadok the priest, "Aren't you a seer? Go back to the city in peace, with your son Ahimaaz and Jonathan son of Abiathar. You and Abiathar take your two sons with you.
- 28 I'll wait at a spot in the wilderness across the river, until I get word from you telling us what's up."
- 28 I will wait at the fords in the desert until word comes from you to inform me."
- 29 So Zadok and Abiathar took the Chest of God back to Jerusalem and placed it there,
- 29 So Zadok and Abiathar took the ark of God back to Jerusalem and stayed there.
- 30 while David went up the Mount of Olives weeping, head covered but barefooted, and the whole army was with him, heads covered and weeping as they ascended.
- 30 But David continued up the Mount of Olives, weeping as he went; his head was covered and he was barefoot. All the people with him covered their heads too and were weeping as they went up.
- 31 David was told, "Ahithophel has joined the conspirators with Absalom." He prayed, "Oh, GOD--turn Ahithophel's counsel to foolishness."
- 31 Now David had been told, "Ahithophel is among the conspirators with Absalom." So David prayed, "O LORD, turn Ahithophel's counsel into foolishness."
- 32 As David approached the top of the hill where God was worshiped, Hushai the Arkite, clothes ripped to shreds and dirt on his head, was there waiting for him.
- 32 When David arrived at the summit, where people used to worship God, Hushai the Arkite was there to meet him, his robe torn and dust on his head.
- 33 David said, "If you come with me, you'll be just one more piece of luggage.
- 33 David said to him, "If you go with me, you will be a burden to me.
- 34 Go back to the city and say to Absalom, 'I'm ready to be your servant, O King; I used to be your father's servant, now I'm your servant.' Do that and you'll be able to confuse Ahithophel's counsel for me.
- 34 But if you return to the city and say to Absalom, 'I will be your servant, O king; I was your father's servant in the past, but now I will be your

- servant,' then you can help me by frustrating Ahithophel's advice.
- 35 The priests Zadok and Abiathar are already there; whatever information you pick up in the palace, tell them.
- 35 Won't the priests Zadok and Abiathar be there with you? Tell them anything you hear in the king's palace.
- 36 Their two sons--Zadok's son Ahimaaz and Abiathar's son Jonathan--are there with them--anything you pick up can be sent to me by them."
- 36 Their two sons, Ahimaaz son of Zadok and Jonathan son of Abiathar, are there with them. Send them to me with anything you hear."
- 37 Hushai, David's friend, arrived at the same time Absalom was entering Jerusalem.
- 37 So David's friend Hushai arrived at Jerusalem as Absalom was entering the city.

2 Samuel 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 Shortly after David passed the crest of the hill, Mephibosheth's steward Ziba met him with a string of pack animals, saddled and loaded with a hundred loaves of bread, a hundred raisin cakes, a hundred baskets of fresh fruit, and a skin of wine.
- 1 When David had gone a short distance beyond the summit, there was Ziba, the steward of Mephibosheth, waiting to meet him. He had a string of donkeys saddled and loaded with two hundred loaves of bread, a hundred cakes of raisins, a hundred cakes of figs and a skin of wine.
- 2 The king said to Ziba, "What's all this?" "The donkeys," said Ziba, "are for the king's household to ride, the bread and fruit are for the servants to eat, and the wine is for drinking, especially for those overcome by fatigue in the wilderness."
- 2 The king asked Ziba, "Why have you brought these?" Ziba answered, "The donkeys are for the king's household to ride on, the bread and fruit are for the men to eat, and the wine is to refresh those who become exhausted in the desert."
- 3 The king said, "And where is your master's grandson?" "He stayed in Jerusalem," said Ziba. "He said, 'This is the day Israel is going to restore

- my grandfather's kingdom to me."
- 3 The king then asked, "Where is your master's grandson?" Ziba said to him, "He is staying in Jerusalem, because he thinks, 'Today the house of Israel will give me back my grandfather's kingdom.' "
- 4 "Everything that belonged to Mephibosheth," said the king, "is now yours." Ziba said, "How can I ever thank you? I'll be forever in your debt, my master and king; may you always look on me with such kindness!"
- 4 Then the king said to Ziba, "All that belonged to Mephibosheth is now yours." "I humbly bow," Ziba said. "May I find favor in your eyes, my lord the king."
- 5 When the king got to Bahurim, a man appeared who had connections with Saul's family. His name was Shimei son of Gera. As he followed along he shouted insults
- 5 As King David approached Bahurim, a man from the same clan as Saul's family came out from there. His name was Shimei son of Gera, and he cursed as he came out.
- 6 and threw rocks right and left at David and his company, servants and soldiers alike.
- 6 He pelted David and all the king's officials with stones, though all the troops and the special guard were on David's right and left.
- 7 To the accompaniment of curses he shouted, "Get lost, get lost, you butcher, you hellhound!
- 7 As he cursed, Shimei said, "Get out, get out, you man of blood, you scoundrel!
- 8 GOD has paid you back for all your dirty work in the family of Saul and for stealing his kingdom. GOD has given the kingdom to your son Absalom. Look at you now--ruined! And good riddance, you pathetic old man!"
- 8 The LORD has repaid you for all the blood you shed in the household of Saul, in whose place you have reigned. The LORD has handed the kingdom over to your son Absalom. You have come to ruin because you are a man of blood!"
- 9 Abishai son of Zeruiah said, "This mangy dog can't insult my master the king this way--let me go over and cut off his head!"

- 9 Then Abishai son of Zeruiah said to the king, "Why should this dead dog curse my lord the king? Let me go over and cut off his head."
- 10 But the king said, "Why are you sons of Zeruiah always interfering and getting in the way? If he's cursing, it's because GOD told him, 'Curse David.' So who dares raise questions?"
- 10 But the king said, "What do you and I have in common, you sons of Zeruiah? If he is cursing because the LORD said to him, 'Curse David,' who can ask, 'Why do you do this?' "
- 11 "Besides," continued David to Abishai and the rest of his servants, "my own son, my flesh and bone, is right now trying to kill me; compared to that this Benjaminite is small potatoes. Don't bother with him; let him curse; he's preaching GOD's word to me.
- 11 David then said to Abishai and all his officials, "My son, who is of my own flesh, is trying to take my life. How much more, then, this Benjamite! Leave him alone; let him curse, for the LORD has told him to.
- 12 And who knows, maybe GOD will see the trouble I'm in today and exchange the curses for something good."
- 12 It may be that the LORD will see my distress and repay me with good for the cursing I am receiving today."
- 13 David and his men went on down the road, while Shimei followed along on the ridge of the hill alongside, cursing, throwing stones down on them, and kicking up dirt.
- 13 So David and his men continued along the road while Shimei was going along the hillside opposite him, cursing as he went and throwing stones at him and showering him with dirt.
- 14 By the time they reached the Jordan River, David and all the men of the company were exhausted. There they rested and were revived.
- 14 The king and all the people with him arrived at their destination exhausted. And there he refreshed himself.
- 15 By this time Absalom and all his men were in Jerusalem. And Ahithophel was with them.
- 15 Meanwhile, Absalom and all the men of Israel came to Jerusalem, and Ahithophel was with him.
- 16 Soon after, Hushai the Arkite, David's friend, came and greeted Absalom, "Long live the king! Long live the king!"

- 16 Then Hushai the Arkite, David's friend, went to Absalom and said to him, "Long live the king! Long live the king!"
- 17 Absalom said to Hushai, "Is this the way you show devotion to your good friend? Why didn't you go with your friend David?"
- 17 Absalom asked Hushai, "Is this the love you show your friend? Why didn't you go with your friend?"
- 18 "Because," said Hushai, "I want to be with the person that GOD and this people and all Israel have chosen. And I want to stay with him.
- 18 Hushai said to Absalom, "No, the one chosen by the LORD, by these people, and by all the men of Israel--his I will be, and I will remain with him.
- 19 Besides, who is there to serve other than the son? Just as I served your father, I'm now ready to serve you."
- 19 Furthermore, whom should I serve? Should I not serve the son? Just as I served your father, so I will serve you."
- 20 Then Absalom spoke to Ahithophel, "Are you ready to give counsel? What do we do next?"
- 20 Absalom said to Ahithophel, "Give us your advice. What should we do?"
- 21 Ahithophel told Absalom, "Go and sleep with your father's concubines, the ones he left to tend to the palace. Everyone will hear that you have openly disgraced your father, and the morale of everyone on your side will be strengthened."
- 21 Ahithophel answered, "Lie with your father's concubines whom he left to take care of the palace. Then all Israel will hear that you have made yourself a stench in your father's nostrils, and the hands of everyone with you will be strengthened."
- 22 So Absalom pitched a tent up on the roof in public view, and went in and slept with his father's concubines.
- 22 So they pitched a tent for Absalom on the roof, and he lay with his father's concubines in the sight of all Israel.
- 23 The counsel that Ahithophel gave in those days was treated as if God himself had spoken. That was the reputation of Ahithophel's counsel to David; it was the same with Absalom.
- 23 Now in those days the advice Ahithophel gave was like that of one who inquires of God. That was how both David and Absalom regarded all of

Ahithophel's advice.

2 Samuel 17

MSG

NIV

- 1 Next Ahithophel advised Absalom, "Let me handpick twelve thousand men and go after David tonight.
- 1 Ahithophel said to Absalom, "I would choose twelve thousand men and set out tonight in pursuit of David.
- 2 I'll come on him when he's bone tired and take him by complete surprise. The whole army will run off and I'll kill only David.
- 2 I would attack him while he is weary and weak. I would strike him with terror, and then all the people with him will flee. I would strike down only the king
- 3 Then I'll bring the army back to you--a bride brought back to her husband! You're only after one man, after all. Then everyone will be together in peace!"
- 3 and bring all the people back to you. The death of the man you seek will mean the return of all; all the people will be unharmed."
- 4 Absalom thought it was an excellent strategy, and all the elders of Israel agreed.
- 4 This plan seemed good to Absalom and to all the elders of Israel.
- 5 But then Absalom said, "Call in Hushai the Arkite--let's hear what he has to say."
- 5 But Absalom said, "Summon also Hushai the Arkite, so we can hear what he has to say."
- 6 So Hushai came and Absalom put it to him, "This is what Ahithophel advised. Should we do it? What do you say?"
- 6 When Hushai came to him, Absalom said, "Ahithophel has given this advice. Should we do what he says? If not, give us your opinion."
- 7 Hushai said, "The counsel that Ahithophel has given in this instance is not good.
- 7 Hushai replied to Absalom, "The advice Ahithophel has given is not good this time.

- 8 You know your father and his men, brave and bitterly angry--like a bear robbed of her cubs. And your father is an experienced fighter; you can be sure he won't be caught napping at a time like this.
- 8 You know your father and his men; they are fighters, and as fierce as a wild bear robbed of her cubs. Besides, your father is an experienced fighter; he will not spend the night with the troops.
- 9 Even while we're talking, he's probably holed up in some cave or other. If he jumps your men from ambush, word will soon get back, 'A slaughter of Absalom's army!'
- 9 Even now, he is hidden in a cave or some other place. If he should attack your troops first, whoever hears about it will say, 'There has been a slaughter among the troops who follow Absalom.'
- 10 Even if your men are valiant with hearts of lions, they'll fall apart at such news, for everyone in Israel knows the kind of fighting stuff your father's made of, and also the men with him.
- 10 Then even the bravest soldier, whose heart is like the heart of a lion, will melt with fear, for all Israel knows that your father is a fighter and that those with him are brave.
- 11 "Here's what I'd advise: Muster the whole country, from Dan to Beersheba, an army like the sand of the sea, and you personally lead them.
- 11 So I advise you: Let all Israel, from Dan to Beersheba--as numerous as the sand on the seashore--be gathered to you, with you yourself leading them into battle.
- 12 We'll smoke him out wherever he is, fall on him like dew falls on the earth, and, believe me, there won't be a single survivor.
- 12 Then we will attack him wherever he may be found, and we will fall on him as dew settles on the ground. Neither he nor any of his men will be left alive.
- 13 If he hides out in a city, then the whole army will bring ropes to that city and pull it down and into a gully--not so much as a pebble left of it!"
- 13 If he withdraws into a city, then all Israel will bring ropes to that city, and we will drag it down to the valley until not even a piece of it can be found."
- 14 Absalom and all his company agreed that the counsel of Hushai the Arkite was better than the counsel of Ahithophel. (GOD had determined

- to discredit the counsel of Ahithophel so as to bring ruin on Absalom.)
- 14 Absalom and all the men of Israel said, "The advice of Hushai the Arkite is better than that of Ahithophel." For the LORD had determined to frustrate the good advice of Ahithophel in order to bring disaster on Absalom.
- 15 Then Hushai told the priests Zadok and Abiathar, "Ahithophel advised Absalom and the elders of Israel thus and thus, and I advised them thus and thus.
- 15 Hushai told Zadok and Abiathar, the priests, "Ahithophel has advised Absalom and the elders of Israel to do such and such, but I have advised them to do so and so.
- 16 Now send this message as quickly as possible to David: 'Don't spend the night on this side of the river; cross immediately or the king and everyone with him will be swallowed up alive.'"
- 16 Now send a message immediately and tell David, 'Do not spend the night at the fords in the desert; cross over without fail, or the king and all the people with him will be swallowed up.' "
- 17 Jonathan and Ahimaaz were waiting around at En Rogel. A servant girl would come and give them messages and then they would go and tell King David, for it wasn't safe to be seen coming into the city.
- 17 Jonathan and Ahimaaz were staying at En Rogel. A servant girl was to go and inform them, and they were to go and tell King David, for they could not risk being seen entering the city.
- 18 But a soldier spotted them and told Absalom, so the two of them got out of there fast and went to a man's house in Bahurim. He had a well in his yard and they climbed into it.
- 18 But a young man saw them and told Absalom. So the two of them left quickly and went to the house of a man in Bahurim. He had a well in his courtyard, and they climbed down into it.
- 19 The wife took a rug and covered the well, then spread grain on it so no one would notice anything out of the ordinary.
- 19 His wife took a covering and spread it out over the opening of the well and scattered grain over it. No one knew anything about it.
- 20 Shortly, Absalom's servants came to the woman's house and asked her, "Have you seen Ahimaaz and Jonathan?" The woman said, "They were

- headed toward the river." They looked but didn't find them, and then went back to Jerusalem.
- 20 When Absalom's men came to the woman at the house, they asked, "Where are Ahimaaz and Jonathan?" The woman answered them, "They crossed over the brook." The men searched but found no one, so they returned to Jerusalem.
- 21 When the coast was clear, Ahimaaz and Jonathan climbed out of the well and went on to make their report to King David, "Get up and cross the river quickly; Ahithophel has given counsel against you!"
- 21 After the men had gone, the two climbed out of the well and went to inform King David. They said to him, "Set out and cross the river at once; Ahithophel has advised such and such against you."
- 22 David and his whole army were soon up and moving and crossed the Jordan. As morning broke there was not a single person who had not made it across the Jordan.
- 22 So David and all the people with him set out and crossed the Jordan. By daybreak, no one was left who had not crossed the Jordan.
- 23 When Ahithophel realized that his counsel was not followed, he saddled his donkey and left for his hometown. After making out his will and putting his house in order, he hanged himself and died. He was buried in the family tomb.
- 23 When Ahithophel saw that his advice had not been followed, he saddled his donkey and set out for his house in his hometown. He put his house in order and then hanged himself. So he died and was buried in his father's tomb.
- 24 About the time David arrived at Mahanaim, Absalom crossed the Jordan, and the whole army of Israel with him.
- 24 David went to Mahanaim, and Absalom crossed the Jordan with all the men of Israel.
- 25 Absalom had made Amasa head of the army, replacing Joab. (Amasa was the son of a man named Ithra, an Ishmaelite who had married Abigail, daughter of Nahash and sister of Zeruiah, the mother of Joab.)
- 25 Absalom had appointed Amasa over the army in place of Joab. Amasa was the son of a man named Jether, an Israelite who had married Abigail, the daughter of Nahash and sister of Zeruiah the mother of Joab.
- 26 Israel and Absalom set camp in Gilead.

- 26 The Israelites and Absalom camped in the land of Gilead.
- 27 When David arrived at Mahanaim, Shobi son of Nahash from Ammonite Rabbah, and Makir son of Ammiel from Lo Debar, and Barzillai the Gileadite from Rogelim
- 27 When David came to Mahanaim, Shobi son of Nahash from Rabbah of the Ammonites, and Makir son of Ammiel from Lo Debar, and Barzillai the Gileadite from Rogelim
- 28 brought beds and blankets, bowls and jugs filled with wheat, barley, flour, roasted grain, beans and lentils,
- 28 brought bedding and bowls and articles of pottery. They also brought wheat and barley, flour and roasted grain, beans and lentils,
- 29 honey, and curds and cheese from the flocks and herds. They presented all this to David and his army to eat, "because," they said, "the army must be starved and exhausted and thirsty out in this wilderness."
- 29 honey and curds, sheep, and cheese from cows' milk for David and his people to eat. For they said, "The people have become hungry and tired and thirsty in the desert."

2 Samuel 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 David organized his forces. He appointed captains of thousands and captains of hundreds.
- 1 David mustered the men who were with him and appointed over them commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds.
- 2 Then David deployed his troops, a third under Joab, a third under Abishai son of Zeruiah, Joab's brother, and a third under Ittai the Gittite. The king then announced, "I'm marching with you."
- 2 David sent the troops out--a third under the command of Joab, a third under Joab's brother Abishai son of Zeruiah, and a third under Ittai the Gittite. The king told the troops, "I myself will surely march out with you."
- 3 They said, "No, you mustn't march with us. If we're forced to retreat, the enemy won't give it a second thought. And if half of us die, they won't

- do so either. But you are worth ten thousand of us. It will be better for us if you stay in the city and help from there."
- 3 But the men said, "You must not go out; if we are forced to flee, they won't care about us. Even if half of us die, they won't care; but you are worth ten thousand of us. It would be better now for you to give us support from the city."
- 4 "If you say so," said the king. "I'll do what you think is best." And so he stood beside the city gate as the whole army marched out by hundreds and by thousands.
- 4 The king answered, "I will do whatever seems best to you." So the king stood beside the gate while all the men marched out in units of hundreds and of thousands.
- 5 Then the king ordered Joab and Abishai and Ittai, "Deal gently for my sake with the young man Absalom." The whole army heard what the king commanded the three captains regarding Absalom.
- 5 The king commanded Joab, Abishai and Ittai, "Be gentle with the young man Absalom for my sake." And all the troops heard the king giving orders concerning Absalom to each of the commanders.
- 6 The army took the field to meet Israel. It turned out that the battle was joined in the Forest of Ephraim.
- 6 The army marched into the field to fight Israel, and the battle took place in the forest of Ephraim.
- 7 The army of Israel was beaten badly there that day by David's men, a terrific slaughter--twenty thousand men!
- 7 There the army of Israel was defeated by David's men, and the casualties that day were great-- twenty thousand men.
- 8 There was fighting helter-skelter all over the place--the forest claimed more lives that day than the sword!
- 8 The battle spread out over the whole countryside, and the forest claimed more lives that day than the sword.
- 9 Absalom ran into David's men, but was out in front of them riding his mule, when the mule ran under the branches of a huge oak tree. Absalom's head was caught in the oak and he was left dangling between heaven and earth, the mule running right out from under him.
- 9 Now Absalom happened to meet David's men. He was riding his mule, and as the mule went under the thick branches of a large oak, Absalom's

- head got caught in the tree. He was left hanging in midair, while the mule he was riding kept on going.
- 10 A solitary soldier saw him and reported it to Joab, "I just saw Absalom hanging from an oak tree!"
- 10 When one of the men saw this, he told Joab, "I just saw Absalom hanging in an oak tree."
- 11 Joab said to the man who told him, "If you saw him, why didn't you kill him then and there? I'd have rewarded you with ten pieces of silver and a fancy belt."
- 11 Joab said to the man who had told him this, "What! You saw him? Why didn't you strike him to the ground right there? Then I would have had to give you ten shekels of silver and a warrior's belt."
- 12 The man told Joab, "Even if I'd had a chance at a thousand pieces of silver, I wouldn't have laid a hand on the king's son. We all heard the king command you and Abishai and Ittai, 'For my sake, protect the young man Absalom.'
- 12 But the man replied, "Even if a thousand shekels were weighed out into my hands, I would not lift my hand against the king's son. In our hearing the king commanded you and Abishai and Ittai, 'Protect the young man Absalom for my sake. '
- 13 Why, I'd be risking my life, for nothing is hidden from the king. And you would have just stood there!"
- 13 And if I had put my life in jeopardy--and nothing is hidden from the king--you would have kept your distance from me."
- 14 Joab said, "I can't waste my time with you." He then grabbed three knives and stabbed Absalom in the heart while he was still alive in the tree;
- 14 Joab said, "I'm not going to wait like this for you." So he took three javelins in his hand and plunged them into Absalom's heart while Absalom was still alive in the oak tree.
- 15 by then Absalom was surrounded by ten of Joab's armor bearers; they hacked away at him and killed him.
- 15 And ten of Joab's armor-bearers surrounded Absalom, struck him and killed him.
- 16 Joab then blew the ram's horn trumpet, calling off the army in its pursuit of Israel.

- 16 Then Joab sounded the trumpet, and the troops stopped pursuing Israel, for Joab halted them.
- 17 They took Absalom, dumped him into a huge pit in the forest, and piled an immense mound of rocks over him. Meanwhile the whole army of Israel was in flight, each man making his own way home.
- 17 They took Absalom, threw him into a big pit in the forest and piled up a large heap of rocks over him. Meanwhile, all the Israelites fled to their homes.
- 18 While alive, Absalom had erected for himself a pillar in the Valley of the King, "because," he said, "I have no son to carry on my name." He inscribed the pillar with his own name. To this day it is called "The Absalom Memorial."
- 18 During his lifetime Absalom had taken a pillar and erected it in the King's Valley as a monument to himself, for he thought, "I have no son to carry on the memory of my name." He named the pillar after himself, and it is called Absalom's Monument to this day.
- 19 Ahimaaz, Zadok's son, said, "Let me run to the king and bring him the good news that GOD has delivered him from his enemies."
- 19 Now Ahimaaz son of Zadok said, "Let me run and take the news to the king that the LORD has delivered him from the hand of his enemies."
- 20 But Joab said, "You're not the one to deliver the good news today; some other day, maybe, but it's not 'good news' today." (This was because the king's son was dead.)
- 20 You are not the one to take the news today, Joab told him. "You may take the news another time, but you must not do so today, because the king's son is dead."
- 21 Then Joab ordered a Cushite, "You go. Tell the king what you've seen." "Yes sir," said the Cushite, and ran off.
- 21 Then Joab said to a Cushite, "Go, tell the king what you have seen." The Cushite bowed down before Joab and ran off.
- 22 Ahimaaz son of Zadok kept at it, begging Joab, "What does it matter? Let me run too, following the Cushite." Joab said, "Why all this 'Run, run'? You'll get no thanks for it, I can tell you."
- 22 Ahimaaz son of Zadok again said to Joab, "Come what may, please let me run behind the Cushite." But Joab replied, "My son, why do you want to go? You don't have any news that will bring you a reward."

23 "I don't care; let me run." "Okay," said Joab, "run." So Ahimaaz ran, taking the lower valley road, and passed the Cushite.

23 He said, "Come what may, I want to run." So Joab said, "Run!" Then Ahimaaz ran by way of the plain and outran the Cushite.

24 David was sitting between the two gates. The sentry had gone up to the top of the gate on the wall and looked around. He saw a solitary runner.

24 While David was sitting between the inner and outer gates, the watchman went up to the roof of the gateway by the wall. As he looked out, he saw a man running alone.

25 The sentry called down and told the king. The king said, "If he's alone, it must be good news!" As the runner came closer,

25 The watchman called out to the king and reported it. The king said, "If he is alone, he must have good news." And the man came closer and closer.

26 the sentry saw another runner and called down to the gate, "Another runner all by himself." And the king said, "This also must be good news."

26 Then the watchman saw another man running, and he called down to the gatekeeper, "Look, another man running alone!" The king said, "He must be bringing good news, too."

27 Then the sentry said, "I can see the first man now; he runs like Ahimaaz son of Zadok." "He's a good man," said the king. "He's bringing good news for sure."

27 The watchman said, "It seems to me that the first one runs like Ahimaaz son of Zadok." "He's a good man," the king said. "He comes with good news."

28 Then Ahimaaz called out and said to the king, "Peace!" Then he bowed deeply before the king, his face to the ground. "Blessed be your GOD; he has handed over the men who rebelled against my master the king."

28 Then Ahimaaz called out to the king, "All is well!" He bowed down before the king with his face to the ground and said, "Praise be to the LORD your God! He has delivered up the men who lifted their hands against my lord the king."

29 The king asked, "But is the young man Absalom all right?" Ahimaaz said, "I saw a huge ruckus just as Joab was sending me off, but I don't know what it was about."

- 29 The king asked, "Is the young man Absalom safe?" Ahimaaz answered, "I saw great confusion just as Joab was about to send the king's servant and me, your servant, but I don't know what it was."
- 30 The king said, "Step aside and stand over there." So he stepped aside.
- 30 The king said, "Stand aside and wait here." So he stepped aside and stood there.
- 31 Then the Cushite arrived and said, "Good news, my master and king! GOD has given victory today over all those who rebelled against you!"
- 31 Then the Cushite arrived and said, "My lord the king, hear the good news! The LORD has delivered you today from all who rose up against you."
- 32 "But," said the king, "is the young man Absalom all right?" And the Cushite replied, "Would that all of the enemies of my master the king and all who maliciously rose against you end up like that young man."
- 32 The king asked the Cushite, "Is the young man Absalom safe?" The Cushite replied, "May the enemies of my lord the king and all who rise up to harm you be like that young man."
- 33 The king was stunned. Heartbroken, he went up to the room over the gate and wept. As he wept he cried out, O my son Absalom, my dear, dear son Absalom! Why not me rather than you, my death and not yours, O Absalom, my dear, dear son!
- 33 The king was shaken. He went up to the room over the gateway and wept. As he went, he said: "O my son Absalom! My son, my son Absalom! If only I had died instead of you--O Absalom, my son, my son!"

2 Samuel 19

MSG

NIV

- 1 Joab was told that David was weeping and lamenting over Absalom.
- 1 Joab was told, "The king is weeping and mourning for Absalom."
- 2 The day's victory turned into a day of mourning as word passed through the army, "David is grieving over his son."
- 2 And for the whole army the victory that day was turned into mourning, because on that day the troops heard it said, "The king is grieving for his

son."

- 3 The army straggled back to the city that day demoralized, dragging their tails.
- 3 The men stole into the city that day as men steal in who are ashamed when they flee from battle.
- 4 And the king held his face in his hands and lamented loudly, O my son Absalom, Absalom my dear, dear son!
- 4 The king covered his face and cried aloud, "O my son Absalom! O Absalom, my son, my son!"
- 5 But in private Joab rebuked the king: "Now you've done it--knocked the wind out of your loyal servants who have just saved your life, to say nothing of the lives of your sons and daughters, wives and concubines.
- 5 Then Joab went into the house to the king and said, "Today you have humiliated all your men, who have just saved your life and the lives of your sons and daughters and the lives of your wives and concubines.
- 6 What is this--loving those who hate you and hating those who love you? Your actions give a clear message: officers and soldiers mean nothing to you. You know that if Absalom were alive right now, we'd all be dead--would that make you happy?
- 6 You love those who hate you and hate those who love you. You have made it clear today that the commanders and their men mean nothing to you. I see that you would be pleased if Absalom were alive today and all of us were dead.
- 7 Get hold of yourself; get out there and put some heart into your servants! I swear to GOD that if you don't go to them they'll desert; not a soldier will be left here by nightfall. And that will be the worst thing that has happened yet."
- 7 Now go out and encourage your men. I swear by the LORD that if you don't go out, not a man will be left with you by nightfall. This will be worse for you than all the calamities that have come upon you from your youth till now."
- 8 So the king came out and took his place at the city gate. Soon everyone knew: "Oh, look! The king has come out to receive us." And his whole army came and presented itself to the king. But the Israelites had fled the field of battle and gone home.

- 8 So the king got up and took his seat in the gateway. When the men were told, "The king is sitting in the gateway," they all came before him. Meanwhile, the Israelites had fled to their homes.
- 9 Meanwhile, the whole populace was now complaining to its leaders, "Wasn't it the king who saved us time and again from our enemies, and rescued us from the Philistines? And now he has had to flee the country on account of Absalom.
- 9 Throughout the tribes of Israel, the people were all arguing with each other, saying, "The king delivered us from the hand of our enemies; he is the one who rescued us from the hand of the Philistines. But now he has fled the country because of Absalom;
- 10 And now this Absalom whom we made king is dead in battle. So what are you waiting for? Why don't you bring the king back?"
- 10 and Absalom, whom we anointed to rule over us, has died in battle. So why do you say nothing about bringing the king back?"
- 11 When David heard what was being said, he sent word to Zadok and Abiathar, the priests, "Ask the elders of Judah, 'Why are you so laggard in bringing the king back home?
- 11 King David sent this message to Zadok and Abiathar, the priests: "Ask the elders of Judah, 'Why should you be the last to bring the king back to his palace, since what is being said throughout Israel has reached the king at his quarters?
- 12 You're my brothers! You're my own flesh and blood! So why are you the last ones to bring the king back home?"
- 12 You are my brothers, my own flesh and blood. So why should you be the last to bring back the king?"
- 13 And tell Amasa, 'You, too, are my flesh and blood. As God is my witness, I'm making you the permanent commander of the army in place of Joab.'"
- 13 And say to Amasa, 'Are you not my own flesh and blood? May God deal with me, be it ever so severely, if from now on you are not the commander of my army in place of Joab.' "
- 14 He captured the hearts of everyone in Judah. They were unanimous in sending for the king: "Come back, you and all your servants."
- 14 He won over the hearts of all the men of Judah as though they were one man. They sent word to the king, "Return, you and all your men."

- 15 So the king returned. He arrived at the Jordan just as Judah reached Gilgal on their way to welcome the king and escort him across the Jordan.
- 15 Then the king returned and went as far as the Jordan. Now the men of Judah had come to Gilgal to go out and meet the king and bring him across the Jordan.
- 16 Even Shimei son of Gera, the Benjaminite from Bahurim, hurried down to join the men of Judah so he could welcome the king,
- 16 Shimei son of Gera, the Benjamite from Bahurim, hurried down with the men of Judah to meet King David.
- 17 a thousand Benjaminites with him. And Ziba, Saul's steward, with his fifteen sons and twenty servants, waded across the Jordan to meet the king
- 17 With him were a thousand Benjamites, along with Ziba, the steward of Saul's household, and his fifteen sons and twenty servants. They rushed to the Jordan, where the king was.
- 18 and brought his entourage across, doing whatever they could to make the king comfortable. Shimei son of Gera bowed deeply in homage to the king as soon as he was across the Jordan
- 18 They crossed at the ford to take the king's household over and to do whatever he wished. When Shimei son of Gera crossed the Jordan, he fell prostrate before the king
- 19 and said, "Don't think badly of me, my master! Overlook my irresponsible outburst on the day my master the king left Jerusalem--don't hold it against me!
- 19 and said to him, "May my lord not hold me guilty. Do not remember how your servant did wrong on the day my lord the king left Jerusalem. May the king put it out of his mind.
- 20 I know I sinned, but look at me now--the first of all the tribe of Joseph to come down and welcome back my master the king!"
- 20 For I your servant know that I have sinned, but today I have come here as the first of the whole house of Joseph to come down and meet my lord the king."
- 21 Abishai son of Zeruiah interrupted, "Enough of this! Shouldn't we kill him outright? Why, he cursed GOD's anointed!"

- 21 Then Abishai son of Zeruiah said, "Shouldn't Shimei be put to death for this? He cursed the LORD's anointed."
- 22 But David said, "What is it with you sons of Zeruiah? Why do you insist on being so contentious? Nobody is going to be killed today. I am again king over Israel!"
- 22 David replied, "What do you and I have in common, you sons of Zeruiah? This day you have become my adversaries! Should anyone be put to death in Israel today? Do I not know that today I am king over Israel?"
- 23 Then the king turned to Shimei, "You're not going to die." And the king gave him his word.
- 23 So the king said to Shimei, "You shall not die." And the king promised him on oath.
- 24 Next Mephibosheth grandson of Saul arrived from Jerusalem to welcome the king. He hadn't combed his hair or trimmed his beard or washed his clothes from the day the king left until the day he returned safe and sound.
- 24 Mephibosheth, Saul's grandson, also went down to meet the king. He had not taken care of his feet or trimmed his mustache or washed his clothes from the day the king left until the day he returned safely.
- 25 The king said, "And why didn't you come with me, Mephibosheth?"
- 25 When he came from Jerusalem to meet the king, the king asked him, "Why didn't you go with me, Mephibosheth?"
- 26 "My master the king," he said, "my servant betrayed me. I told him to saddle my donkey so I could ride it and go with the king, for, as you know, I am lame.
- 26 He said, "My lord the king, since I your servant am lame, I said, 'I will have my donkey saddled and will ride on it, so I can go with the king.' But Ziba my servant betrayed me.
- 27 And then he lied to you about me. But my master the king has been like one of God's angels: he knew what was right and did it.
- 27 And he has slandered your servant to my lord the king. My lord the king is like an angel of God; so do whatever pleases you.
- 28 Wasn't everyone in my father's house doomed? But you took me in and gave me a place at your table. What more could I ever expect or ask?"

- 28 All my grandfather's descendants deserved nothing but death from my lord the king, but you gave your servant a place among those who sat at your table. So what right do I have to make any more appeals to the king?"
- 29 "That's enough," said the king. "Say no more. Here's my decision: You and Ziba divide the property between you."
- 29 The king said to him, "Why say more? I order you and Ziba to divide the fields."
- 30 Mephibosheth said, "Oh, let him have it all! All I care about is that my master the king is home safe and sound!"
- 30 Mephibosheth said to the king, "Let him take everything, now that my lord the king has arrived home safely."
- 31 Barzillai the Gileadite had come down from Rogelim. He crossed the Jordan with the king to give him a good send-off.
- 31 Barzillai the Gileadite also came down from Rogelim to cross the Jordan with the king and to send him on his way from there.
- 32 Barzillai was a very old man--eighty years old! He had supplied the king's needs all the while he was in Mahanaim since he was very wealthy.
- 32 Now Barzillai was a very old man, eighty years of age. He had provided for the king during his stay in Mahanaim, for he was a very wealthy man.
- 33 "Join me in Jerusalem," the king said to Barzillai. "Let me take care of you."
- 33 The king said to Barzillai, "Cross over with me and stay with me in Jerusalem, and I will provide for you."
- 34 But Barzillai declined the offer, "How long do you think I'd live if I went with the king to Jerusalem?"
- 34 But Barzillai answered the king, "How many more years will I live, that I should go up to Jerusalem with the king?"
- 35 I'm eighty years old and not much good anymore to anyone. Can't taste food; can't hear music. So why add to the burdens of my master the king?
- 35 I am now eighty years old. Can I tell the difference between what is good and what is not? Can your servant taste what he eats and drinks?

- Can I still hear the voices of men and women singers? Why should your servant be an added burden to my lord the king?
- 36 I'll just go a little way across the Jordan with the king. But why would the king need to make a great thing of that?
- 36 Your servant will cross over the Jordan with the king for a short distance, but why should the king reward me in this way?
- 37 Let me go back and die in my hometown and be buried with my father and mother. But my servant Kimham here; let him go with you in my place. But treat him well!"
- 37 Let your servant return, that I may die in my own town near the tomb of my father and mother. But here is your servant Kimham. Let him cross over with my lord the king. Do for him whatever pleases you."
- 38 The king said, "That's settled; Kimham goes with me. And I will treat him well! If you think of anything else, I'll do that for you, too."
- 38 The king said, "Kimham shall cross over with me, and I will do for him whatever pleases you. And anything you desire from me I will do for you."
- 39 The army crossed the Jordan but the king stayed. The king kissed and blessed Barzillai, who then returned home.
- 39 So all the people crossed the Jordan, and then the king crossed over. The king kissed Barzillai and gave him his blessing, and Barzillai returned to his home.
- 40 Then the king, Kimham with him, crossed over at Gilgal. The whole army of Judah and half the army of Israel processed with the king.
- 40 When the king crossed over to Gilgal, Kimham crossed with him. All the troops of Judah and half the troops of Israel had taken the king over.
- 41 The men of Israel came to the king and said, "Why have our brothers, the men of Judah, taken over as if they owned the king, escorting the king and his family and close associates across the Jordan?"
- 41 Soon all the men of Israel were coming to the king and saying to him, "Why did our brothers, the men of Judah, steal the king away and bring him and his household across the Jordan, together with all his men?"
- 42 The men of Judah retorted, "Because the king is related to us, that's why! But why make a scene? You don't see us getting treated special because of it, do you?"

- 42 All the men of Judah answered the men of Israel, "We did this because the king is closely related to us. Why are you angry about it? Have we eaten any of the king's provisions? Have we taken anything for ourselves?"
- 43 The men of Israel shot back, "We have ten shares in the king to your one. Besides we're the firstborn--so why are we having to play second fiddle? It was our idea to bring him back." But the men of Judah took a harder line than the men of Israel.
- 43 Then the men of Israel answered the men of Judah, "We have ten shares in the king; and besides, we have a greater claim on David than you have. So why do you treat us with contempt? Were we not the first to speak of bringing back our king?" But the men of Judah responded even more harshly than the men of Israel.

2 Samuel 20

MSG

NIV

- 1 Just then a good-for-nothing named Sheba son of Bicri the Benjaminite blew a blast on the ram's horn trumpet, calling out, We've got nothing to do with David, there's no future for us with the son of Jesse! Let's get out of here, Israel--head for your tents!
- 1 Now a troublemaker named Sheba son of Bicri, a Benjamite, happened to be there. He sounded the trumpet and shouted, "We have no share in David, no part in Jesse's son! Every man to his tent, O Israel!"
- 2 So all the men of Israel deserted David and followed Sheba son of Bicri. But the men of Judah stayed committed, sticking with their king all the way from the Jordan to Jerusalem.
- 2 So all the men of Israel deserted David to follow Sheba son of Bicri. But the men of Judah stayed by their king all the way from the Jordan to Jerusalem.
- 3 When David arrived home in Jerusalem, the king took the ten concubines he had left to watch the palace and placed them in seclusion, under guard. He provided for their needs but didn't visit them. They were virtual prisoners until they died, widows as long as they lived.

- 3 When David returned to his palace in Jerusalem, he took the ten concubines he had left to take care of the palace and put them in a house under guard. He provided for them, but did not lie with them. They were kept in confinement till the day of their death, living as widows.
- 4 The king ordered Amasa, "Muster the men of Judah for me in three days; then report in."
- 4 Then the king said to Amasa, "Summon the men of Judah to come to me within three days, and be here yourself."
- 5 Amasa went to carry out his orders, but he was late reporting back.
- 5 But when Amasa went to summon Judah, he took longer than the time the king had set for him.
- 6 So David told Abishai, "Sheba son of Bicri is going to hurt us even worse than Absalom did. Take your master's servants and hunt him down before he gets holed up in some fortress city where we can't get to him."
- 6 David said to Abishai, "Now Sheba son of Bicri will do us more harm than Absalom did. Take your master's men and pursue him, or he will find fortified cities and escape from us."
- 7 So under Abishai's command, all the best men--Joab's men and the Kerethites and Pelethites--left Jerusalem to hunt down Sheba son of Bicri.
- 7 So Joab's men and the Kerethites and Pelethites and all the mighty warriors went out under the command of Abishai. They marched out from Jerusalem to pursue Sheba son of Bicri.
- 8 They were near the boulder at Gibeon when Amasa came their way. Joab was wearing a tunic with a sheathed sword strapped on his waist, but the sword slipped out and fell to the ground.
- 8 While they were at the great rock in Gibeon, Amasa came to meet them. Joab was wearing his military tunic, and strapped over it at his waist was a belt with a dagger in its sheath. As he stepped forward, it dropped out of its sheath.
- 9 Joab greeted Amasa, "How are you, brother?" and took Amasa's beard in his right hand as if to kiss him.
- 9 Joab said to Amasa, "How are you, my brother?" Then Joab took Amasa by the beard with his right hand to kiss him.
- 10 Amasa didn't notice the sword in Joab's other hand. Joab stuck him in the belly and his guts spilled to the ground. A second blow wasn't

- needed; he was dead. Then Joab and his brother Abishai continued to chase Sheba son of Bicri.
- 10 Amasa was not on his guard against the dagger in Joab's hand, and Joab plunged it into his belly, and his intestines spilled out on the ground. Without being stabbed again, Amasa died. Then Joab and his brother Abishai pursued Sheba son of Bicri.
- 11 One of Joab's soldiers took up his post over the body and called out, "Everyone who sides with Joab and supports David, follow Joab!"
- 11 One of Joab's men stood beside Amasa and said, "Whoever favors Joab, and whoever is for David, let him follow Joab!"
- 12 Amasa was lying in a pool of blood in the middle of the road; the man realized that the whole army was going to stop and take a look, so he pulled Amasa's corpse off the road into the field and threw a blanket over him so it wouldn't collect spectators.
- 12 Amasa lay wallowing in his blood in the middle of the road, and the man saw that all the troops came to a halt there. When he realized that everyone who came up to Amasa stopped, he dragged him from the road into a field and threw a garment over him.
- 13 As soon as he'd gotten him off the road, the traffic flowed normally, following Joab in the chase after Sheba son of Bicri.
- 13 After Amasa had been removed from the road, all the men went on with Joab to pursue Sheba son of Bicri.
- 14 Sheba passed through all the tribes of Israel as far as Abel Beth Maacah; all the Bicrites clustered and followed him into the city.
- 14 Sheba passed through all the tribes of Israel to Abel Beth Maacah and through the entire region of the Berites, who gathered together and followed him.
- 15 Joab's army arrived and laid siege to Sheba in Abel Beth Maacah. They built a siege-ramp up against the city's fortification. The plan was to knock down the wall.
- 15 All the troops with Joab came and besieged Sheba in Abel Beth Maacah. They built a siege ramp up to the city, and it stood against the outer fortifications. While they were battering the wall to bring it down,
- 16 But a shrewd woman called out from the city, "Listen, everybody! Please tell Joab to come close so I can talk to him."

- 16 a wise woman called from the city, "Listen! Listen! Tell Joab to come here so I can speak to him."
- 17 When he had come, the woman said, "Are you Joab?" He said, "I am." "Then," she said, "listen to what I have to say." He said, "I'm listening."
- 17 He went toward her, and she asked, "Are you Joab?" "I am," he answered. She said, "Listen to what your servant has to say." "I'm listening," he said.
- 18 "There's an old saying in these parts: 'If it's answers you want, come to Abel and get it straight.'
- 18 She continued, "Long ago they used to say, 'Get your answer at Abel,' and that settled it.
- 19 We're a peaceful people here, and reliable. And here you are, trying to tear down one of Israel's mother cities. Why would you want to mess with GOD's legacy like that?"
- 19 We are the peaceful and faithful in Israel. You are trying to destroy a city that is a mother in Israel. Why do you want to swallow up the LORD's inheritance?"
- 20 Joab protested, "Believe me, you've got me all wrong. I'm not here to hurt anyone or destroy anything--not on your life!
- 20 Far be it from me! Joab replied, "Far be it from me to swallow up or destroy!
- 21 But a man from the hill country of Ephraim, Sheba son of Bicri by name, revolted against King David; hand him over, him only, and we'll get out of here." The woman told Joab, "Sounds good. His head will be tossed to you from the wall."
- 21 That is not the case. A man named Sheba son of Bicri, from the hill country of Ephraim, has lifted up his hand against the king, against David. Hand over this one man, and I'll withdraw from the city." The woman said to Joab, "His head will be thrown to you from the wall."
- 22 The woman presented her strategy to the whole city and they did it: They cut off the head of Sheba son of Bicri and tossed it down to Joab. He then blew a blast on the ram's horn trumpet and the soldiers all went home. Joab returned to the king in Jerusalem.
- 22 Then the woman went to all the people with her wise advice, and they cut off the head of Sheba son of Bicri and threw it to Joab. So he

- sounded the trumpet, and his men dispersed from the city, each returning to his home. And Joab went back to the king in Jerusalem.
- 23 Joab was again commander of the whole army of Israel. Benaiah son of Jehoiada was over the Kerethites and Pelethites;
- 23 Joab was over Israel's entire army; Benaiah son of Jehoiada was over the Kerethites and Pelethites;
- 24 Adoniram over the work crews; Jehoshaphat son of Ahilud was clerk;
- 24 Adoniram was in charge of forced labor; Jehoshaphat son of Ahilud was recorder;
- 25 Sheva was historian; Zadok and Abiathar were priests;
- 25 Sheva was secretary; Zadok and Abiathar were priests;
- 26 Ira the Jairite was David's chaplain.
- 26 and Ira the Jairite was David's priest.

2 Samuel 21

MSG

NIV

- 1 There was a famine in David's time. It went on year after year after year--three years. David went to GOD seeking the reason. GOD said, "This is because there is blood on Saul and his house, from the time he massacred the Gibeonites."
- 1 During the reign of David, there was a famine for three successive years; so David sought the face of the LORD. The LORD said, "It is on account of Saul and his blood-stained house; it is because he put the Gibeonites to death."
- 2 So the king called the Gibeonites together for consultation. (The Gibeonites were not part of Israel; they were what was left of the Amorites, and protected by a treaty with Israel. But Saul, a fanatic for the honor of Israel and Judah, tried to kill them off.)
- 2 The king summoned the Gibeonites and spoke to them. (Now the Gibeonites were not a part of Israel but were survivors of the Amorites; the Israelites had sworn to spare them, but Saul in his zeal for Israel and Judah had tried to annihilate them.)
- 3 David addressed the Gibeonites: "What can I do for you? How can I compensate you so that you will bless GOD's legacy of land and

people?"

- 3 David asked the Gibeonites, "What shall I do for you? How shall I make amends so that you will bless the LORD's inheritance?"
- 4 The Gibeonites replied, "We don't want any money from Saul and his family. And it's not up to us to put anyone in Israel to death." But David persisted: "What are you saying I should do for you?"
- 4 The Gibeonites answered him, "We have no right to demand silver or gold from Saul or his family, nor do we have the right to put anyone in Israel to death." "What do you want me to do for you?" David asked.
- 5 Then they told the king, "The man who tried to get rid of us, who schemed to wipe us off the map of Israel--
- 5 They answered the king, "As for the man who destroyed us and plotted against us so that we have been decimated and have no place anywhere in Israel,
- 6 well, let seven of his sons be handed over to us to be executed--hanged before GOD at Gibeah of Saul, the holy mountain." And David agreed, "I'll hand them over to you."
- 6 let seven of his male descendants be given to us to be killed and exposed before the LORD at Gibeah of Saul--the Lord's chosen one." So the king said, "I will give them to you."
- 7 The king spared Mephibosheth son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, because of the promise David and Jonathan had spoken before GOD.
- 7 The king spared Mephibosheth son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, because of the oath before the LORD between David and Jonathan son of Saul.
- 8 But the king selected Armoni and Mephibosheth, the two sons that Rizpah daughter of Aiah had borne to Saul, plus the five sons that Saul's daughter Merab had borne to Adriel son of Barzillai the Meholathite.
- 8 But the king took Armoni and Mephibosheth, the two sons of Aiah's daughter Rizpah, whom she had borne to Saul, together with the five sons of Saul's daughter Merab, whom she had borne to Adriel son of Barzillai the Meholathite.
- 9 He turned them over to the Gibeonites who hanged them on the mountain before GOD--all seven died together. Harvest was just getting underway, the beginning of the barley harvest, when they were executed.
- 9 He handed them over to the Gibeonites, who killed and exposed them on a hill before the LORD. All seven of them fell together; they were put to

death during the first days of the harvest, just as the barley harvest was beginning.

10 Rizpah daughter of Aiah took rough burlap and spread it out for herself on a rock from the beginning of the harvest until the heavy rains started. She kept the birds away from the bodies by day and the wild animals by night.

10 Rizpah daughter of Aiah took sackcloth and spread it out for herself on a rock. From the beginning of the harvest till the rain poured down from the heavens on the bodies, she did not let the birds of the air touch them by day or the wild animals by night.

11 David was told what she had done, this Rizpah daughter of Aiah and concubine of Saul.

11 When David was told what Aiah's daughter Rizpah, Saul's concubine, had done,

12 He then went and got the remains of Saul and Jonathan his son from the leaders at Jabesh Gilead (who had rescued them from the town square at Beth Shan where the Philistines had hung them after striking them down at Gilboa).

12 he went and took the bones of Saul and his son Jonathan from the citizens of Jabesh Gilead. (They had taken them secretly from the public square at Beth Shan, where the Philistines had hung them after they struck Saul down on Gilboa.)

13 He gathered up their remains and brought them together with the dead bodies of the seven who had just been hanged.

13 David brought the bones of Saul and his son Jonathan from there, and the bones of those who had been killed and exposed were gathered up.

14 The bodies were taken back to the land of Benjamin and given a decent burial in the tomb of Kish, Saul's father. They did everything the king ordered to be done. That cleared things up: from then on God responded to Israel's prayers for the land.

14 They buried the bones of Saul and his son Jonathan in the tomb of Saul's father Kish, at Zela in Benjamin, and did everything the king commanded. After that, God answered prayer in behalf of the land.

15 War broke out again between the Philistines and Israel. David and his men went down to fight. David became exhausted.

- 15 Once again there was a battle between the Philistines and Israel. David went down with his men to fight against the Philistines, and he became exhausted.
- 16 Ishbi-Benob, a warrior descended from Rapha, with a spear weighing nearly eight pounds and outfitted in brand-new armor, announced that he'd kill David.
- 16 And Ishbi-Benob, one of the descendants of Rapha, whose bronze spearhead weighed three hundred shekels and who was armed with a new sword, said he would kill David.
- 17 But Abishai son of Zeruiah came to the rescue, struck the Philistine, and killed him. Then David's men swore to him, "No more fighting on the front-lines for you! Don't snuff out the lamp of Israel!"
- 17 But Abishai son of Zeruiah came to David's rescue; he struck the Philistine down and killed him. Then David's men swore to him, saying, "Never again will you go out with us to battle, so that the lamp of Israel will not be extinguished."
- 18 Later there was another skirmish with the Philistines at Gob. That time Sibbecai the Hushathite killed Saph, another of the warriors descended from Rapha.
- 18 In the course of time, there was another battle with the Philistines, at Gob. At that time Sibbecai the Hushathite killed Saph, one of the descendants of Rapha.
- 19 At yet another battle with the Philistines at Gob, Elhanan son of Jaar, the weaver of Bethlehem, killed Goliath the Gittite whose spear was as big as a flagpole.
- 19 In another battle with the Philistines at Gob, Elhanan son of Jaare-Oregim the Bethlehemite killed Goliath the Gittite, who had a spear with a shaft like a weaver's rod.
- 20 Still another fight broke out in Gath. There was a giant there with six fingers on his hands and six toes on his feet--twenty-four fingers and toes! He was another of those descended from Rapha.
- 20 In still another battle, which took place at Gath, there was a huge man with six fingers on each hand and six toes on each foot--twenty-four in all. He also was descended from Rapha.
- 21 He insulted Israel, and Jonathan son of Shimeah, David's brother, killed him.

- 21 When he taunted Israel, Jonathan son of Shimeah, David's brother, killed him.
- 22 These four were descended from Rapha in Gath. And they all were killed by David and his soldiers.
- 22 These four were descendants of Rapha in Gath, and they fell at the hands of David and his men.

2 Samuel 22

MSG

NIV

- 1 David prayed to GOD the words of this song after GOD saved him from all his enemies and from Saul.
- 1 David sang to the LORD the words of this song when the LORD delivered him from the hand of all his enemies and from the hand of Saul.
- 2 GOD is bedrock under my feet, the castle in which I live, my rescuing knight.
- 2 He said: "The LORD is my rock, my fortress and my deliverer;
- 3 My God--the high crag where I run for dear life, hiding behind the boulders, safe in the granite hideout; My mountaintop refuge, he saves me from ruthless men.
- 3 my God is my rock, in whom I take refuge, my shield and the horn of my salvation. He is my stronghold, my refuge and my savior-- from violent men you save me.
- 4 I sing to GOD the Praise-Lofty, and find myself safe and saved.
- 4 I call to the LORD, who is worthy of praise, and I am saved from my enemies.
- 5 The waves of death crashed over me, devil waters rushed over me.
- 5 The waves of death swirled about me; the torrents of destruction overwhelmed me.
- 6 Hell's ropes cinched me tight; death traps barred every exit.
- 6 The cords of the grave coiled around me; the snares of death confronted me.
- 7 A hostile world! I called to GOD, to my God I cried out. From his palace he heard me call; my cry brought me right into his presence-- a private

audience!

- 7 In my distress I called to the LORD; I called out to my God. From his temple he heard my voice; my cry came to his ears.
- 8 Earth wobbled and lurched; the very heavens shook like leaves, Quaked like aspen leaves because of his rage.
- 8 The earth trembled and quaked, the foundations of the heavens shook; they trembled because he was angry.
- 9 His nostrils flared, billowing smoke; his mouth spit fire. Tongues of fire darted in and out;
- 9 Smoke rose from his nostrils; consuming fire came from his mouth, burning coals blazed out of it.
- 10 he lowered the sky. He stepped down; under his feet an abyss opened up.
- 10 He parted the heavens and came down; dark clouds were under his feet.
- 11 He rode a winged creature, swift on wind-wings.
- 11 He mounted the cherubim and flew; he soared on the wings of the wind.
- 12 He wrapped himself in a trenchcoat of black rain-cloud darkness.
- 12 He made darkness his canopy around him-- the dark rain clouds of the sky.
- 13 But his cloud-brightness burst through, a grand comet of fireworks.
- 13 Out of the brightness of his presence bolts of lightning blazed forth.
- 14 Then GOD thundered out of heaven; the High God gave a great shout.
- 14 The LORD thundered from heaven; the voice of the Most High resounded.
- 15 God shot his arrows--pandemonium! He hurled his lightnings--a rout!
- 15 He shot arrows and scattered the enemies, bolts of lightning and routed them.
- 16 The secret sources of ocean were exposed, the hidden depths of earth lay uncovered The moment GOD roared in protest, let loose his hurricane anger.
- 16 The valleys of the sea were exposed and the foundations of the earth laid bare at the rebuke of the LORD, at the blast of breath from his nostrils.
- 17 But me he caught--reached all the way from sky to sea; he pulled me out

17 He reached down from on high and took hold of me; he drew me out of deep waters.

18 Of that ocean of hate, that enemy chaos, the void in which I was drowning.

18 He rescued me from my powerful enemy, from my foes, who were too strong for me.

19 They hit me when I was down, but GOD stuck by me.

19 They confronted me in the day of my disaster, but the LORD was my support.

20 He stood me up on a wide-open field; I stood there saved--surprised to be loved!

20 He brought me out into a spacious place; he rescued me because he delighted in me.

21 GOD made my life complete when I placed all the pieces before him. When I cleaned up my act, he gave me a fresh start.

21 The LORD has dealt with me according to my righteousness; according to the cleanness of my hands he has rewarded me.

22 Indeed, I've kept alert to GOD's ways; I haven't taken God for granted.

22 For I have kept the ways of the LORD; I have not done evil by turning from my God.

23 Every day I review the ways he works, I try not to miss a trick.

23 All his laws are before me; I have not turned away from his decrees.

24 I feel put back together, and I'm watching my step.

24 I have been blameless before him and have kept myself from sin.

25 GOD rewrote the text of my life when I opened the book of my heart to his eyes.

25 The LORD has rewarded me according to my righteousness, according to my cleanness in his sight.

26 You stick by people who stick with you, you're straight with people who're straight with you,

26 To the faithful you show yourself faithful, to the blameless you show yourself blameless,

27 You're good to good people, you shrewdly work around the bad ones.

27 to the pure you show yourself pure, but to the crooked you show yourself shrewd.

28 You take the side of the down-and-out, but the stuck-up you take down a peg.

28 You save the humble, but your eyes are on the haughty to bring them low.

29 Suddenly, GOD, your light floods my path, GOD drives out the darkness.

29 You are my lamp, O LORD; the LORD turns my darkness into light.

30 I smash the bands of marauders, I vault the high fences.

30 With your help I can advance against a troop; with my God I can scale a wall.

31 What a God! His road stretches straight and smooth. Every GOD-direction is road-tested. Everyone who runs toward him Makes it.

31 As for God, his way is perfect; the word of the LORD is flawless. He is a shield for all who take refuge in him.

32 Is there any god like GOD? Are we not at bedrock?

32 For who is God besides the LORD? And who is the Rock except our God?

33 Is not this the God who armed me well, then aimed me in the right direction?

33 It is God who arms me with strength and makes my way perfect.

34 Now I run like a deer; I'm king of the mountain.

34 He makes my feet like the feet of a deer; he enables me to stand on the heights.

35 He shows me how to fight; I can bend a bronze bow!

35 He trains my hands for battle; my arms can bend a bow of bronze.

36 You protect me with salvation-armor; you touch me and I feel ten feet tall.

36 You give me your shield of victory; you stoop down to make me great.

37 You cleared the ground under me so my footing was firm.

37 You broaden the path beneath me, so that my ankles do not turn.

38 When I chased my enemies I caught them; I didn't let go till they were dead men.

38 I pursued my enemies and crushed them; I did not turn back till they were destroyed.

39 I nailed them; they were down for good; then I walked all over them.

39 I crushed them completely, and they could not rise; they fell beneath my feet.

40 You armed me well for this fight; you smashed the upstarts.

40 You armed me with strength for battle; you made my adversaries bow at my feet.

41 You made my enemies turn tail, and I wiped out the haters.

41 You made my enemies turn their backs in flight, and I destroyed my foes.

42 They cried "uncle" but Uncle didn't come; They yelled for GOD and got no for an answer.

42 They cried for help, but there was no one to save them-- to the LORD, but he did not answer.

43 I ground them to dust; they gusted in the wind. I threw them out, like garbage in the gutter.

43 I beat them as fine as the dust of the earth; I pounded and trampled them like mud in the streets.

44 You rescued me from a squabbling people; you made me a leader of nations. People I'd never heard of served me;

44 You have delivered me from the attacks of my people; you have preserved me as the head of nations. People I did not know are subject to me,

45 the moment they got wind of me they submitted.

45 and foreigners come cringing to me; as soon as they hear me, they obey me.

46 They gave up; they came trembling from their hideouts.

46 They all lose heart; they come trembling from their strongholds.

47 Live, GOD! Blessing to my Rock, my towering Salvation-God!

47 The LORD lives! Praise be to my Rock! Exalted be God, the Rock, my Savior!

48 This God set things right for me and shut up the people who talked back.

48 He is the God who avenges me, who puts the nations under me,

49 He rescued me from enemy anger. You pulled me from the grip of upstarts, You saved me from the bullies.

49 who sets me free from my enemies. You exalted me above my foes; from violent men you rescued me.

- 50 That's why I'm thanking you, GOD, all over the world. That's why I'm singing songs that rhyme your name.
- 50 Therefore I will praise you, O LORD, among the nations; I will sing praises to your name.
- 51 God's king takes the trophy; God's chosen is beloved. I mean David and all his children-- always.
- 51 He gives his king great victories; he shows unfailing kindness to his anointed, to David and his descendants forever."

2 Samuel 23

MSG

NIV

- 1 These are David's last words: The voice of the son of Jesse, the voice of the man God took to the top, Whom the God of Jacob made king, and Israel's most popular singer!
- 1 These are the last words of David: "The oracle of David son of Jesse, the oracle of the man exalted by the Most High, the man anointed by the God of Jacob, Israel's singer of songs:
- 2 GOD's Spirit spoke through me, his words took shape on my tongue.
- 2 The Spirit of the LORD spoke through me; his word was on my tongue.
- 3 The God of Israel spoke to me, Israel's Rock-Mountain said, "Whoever governs fairly and well, who rules in the Fear-of-God,
- 3 The God of Israel spoke, the Rock of Israel said to me: 'When one rules over men in righteousness, when he rules in the fear of God,
- 4 Is like first light at daybreak without a cloud in the sky, Like green grass carpeting earth, glistening under fresh rain."
- 4 he is like the light of morning at sunrise on a cloudless morning, like the brightness after rain that brings the grass from the earth.'
- 5 And this is just how my regime has been, for God guaranteed his covenant with me, Spelled it out plainly and kept every promised word-- My entire salvation, my every desire.
- 5 Is not my house right with God? Has he not made with me an everlasting covenant, arranged and secured in every part? Will he not bring to fruition my salvation and grant me my every desire?
- 6 But the devil's henchmen are like thorns culled and piled as trash;

- 6 But evil men are all to be cast aside like thorns, which are not gathered with the hand.
- 7 Better not try to touch them; keep your distance with a rake or hoe. They'll make a glorious bonfire!
- 7 Whoever touches thorns uses a tool of iron or the shaft of a spear; they are burned up where they lie."
- 8 This is the listing of David's top men. Josheb-Basshebeth, the Tahkemonite. He was chief of the Three. He once put his spear to work against eight hundred--killed them all in a day.
- 8 These are the names of David's mighty men: Josheb-Basshebeth, a Tahkemonite, was chief of the Three; he raised his spear against eight hundred men, whom he killed in one encounter.
- 9 Eleazar son of Dodai the Ahohite was the next of the elite Three. He was with David when the Philistines poked fun at them at Pas Dammim. When the Philistines drew up for battle, Israel retreated.
- 9 Next to him was Eleazar son of Dodai the Ahohite. As one of the three mighty men, he was with David when they taunted the Philistines gathered at Pas Dammim for battle. Then the men of Israel retreated,
- 10 But Eleazar stood his ground and killed Philistines right and left until he was exhausted--but he never let go of his sword! A big win for GOD that day. The army then rejoined Eleazar, but all there was left to do was the clean-up.
- 10 but he stood his ground and struck down the Philistines till his hand grew tired and froze to the sword. The LORD brought about a great victory that day. The troops returned to Eleazar, but only to strip the dead.
- 11 Shammah son of Agee the Hararite was the third of the Three. The Philistines had mustered for battle at Lehi, where there was a field full of lentils. Israel fled before the Philistines,
- 11 Next to him was Shammah son of Agee the Hararite. When the Philistines banded together at a place where there was a field full of lentils, Israel's troops fled from them.
- 12 but Shammah took his stand at the center of the field, successfully defended it, and routed the Philistines. Another great victory for GOD!
- 12 But Shammah took his stand in the middle of the field. He defended it and struck the Philistines down, and the LORD brought about a great

victory.

- 13 One day during harvest, the Three parted from the Thirty and joined David at the Cave of Adullam. A squad of Philistines had set up camp in the Valley of Rephaim.
- 13 During harvest time, three of the thirty chief men came down to David at the cave of Adullam, while a band of Philistines was encamped in the Valley of Rephaim.
- 14 While David was holed up in the Cave, the Philistines had their base camp in Bethlehem.
- 14 At that time David was in the stronghold, and the Philistine garrison was at Bethlehem.
- 15 David had a sudden craving and said, "Would I ever like a drink of water from the well at the gate of Bethlehem!"
- 15 David longed for water and said, "Oh, that someone would get me a drink of water from the well near the gate of Bethlehem!"
- 16 So the Three penetrated the Philistine lines, drew water from the well at the gate of Bethlehem, and brought it back to David. But David wouldn't drink it; he poured it out as an offering to GOD,
- 16 So the three mighty men broke through the Philistine lines, drew water from the well near the gate of Bethlehem and carried it back to David. But he refused to drink it; instead, he poured it out before the LORD.
- 17 saying, "There is no way, GOD, that I'll drink this! This isn't mere water, it's their life-blood--they risked their very lives to bring it!" So David refused to drink it. This is the sort of thing that the Three did.
- 17 Far be it from me, O LORD, to do this! he said. "Is it not the blood of men who went at the risk of their lives?" And David would not drink it. Such were the exploits of the three mighty men.
- 18 Abishai brother of Joab and son of Zeruiah was the head of the Thirty. He once got credit for killing three hundred with his spear, but he was never named in the same breath as the Three.
- 18 Abishai the brother of Joab son of Zeruiah was chief of the Three. He raised his spear against three hundred men, whom he killed, and so he became as famous as the Three.
- 19 He was the most respected of the Thirty and was their captain, but never got included among the Three.

- 19 Was he not held in greater honor than the Three? He became their commander, even though he was not included among them.
- 20 Benaiah son of Jehoiada from Kabzeel was a vigorous man who accomplished a great deal. He once killed two lion cubs in Moab. Another time, on a snowy day, he climbed down into a pit and killed a lion.
- 20 Benaiah son of Jehoiada was a valiant fighter from Kabzeel, who performed great exploits. He struck down two of Moab's best men. He also went down into a pit on a snowy day and killed a lion.
- 21 Another time he killed a formidable Egyptian. The Egyptian was armed with a spear and Benaiah went against him with nothing but a walking stick; he seized the spear from his grip and killed him with his own spear.
- 21 And he struck down a huge Egyptian. Although the Egyptian had a spear in his hand, Benaiah went against him with a club. He snatched the spear from the Egyptian's hand and killed him with his own spear.
- 22 These are the things that Benaiah son of Jehoiada is famous for. But neither did he ever get ranked with the Three.
- 22 Such were the exploits of Benaiah son of Jehoiada; he too was as famous as the three mighty men.
- 23 He was held in greatest respect among the Thirty, but he never got included with the Three. David put him in charge of his bodyguard.
- 23 He was held in greater honor than any of the Thirty, but he was not included among the Three. And David put him in charge of his bodyguard.
- 24 "The Thirty" consisted of: Asahel brother of Joab; Elhanan son of Dodo of Bethlehem;
- 24 Among the Thirty were: Asahel the brother of Joab, Elhanan son of Dodo from Bethlehem,
- 25 Shammah the Harodite; Elikah the Harodite;
- 25 Shammah the Harodite, Elikah the Harodite,
- 26 Helez the Paltite; Ira son of Ikkesh the Tekoite;
- 26 Helez the Paltite, Ira son of Ikkesh from Tekoa,
- 27 Abiezer the Anathothite; Sibbecai the Hushathite;
- 27 Abiezer from Anathoth, Mebunnai the Hushathite,
- 28 Zalmon the Ahohite; Maharai the Netophathite;

28 Zalmon the Ahohite, Maharai the Netophathite,
 29 Heled son of Baanah the Netophathite; Ithai son of Ribai from Gibeah
 of the Benjaminites;
 29 Heled son of Baanah the Netophathite, Ithai son of Ribai from Gibeah
 in Benjamin,
 30 Benaiah the Pirathonite; Hiddai from the badlands of Gaash;
 30 Benaiah the Pirathonite, Hiddai from the ravines of Gaash,
 31 Abi-Albon the Arbathite; Azmaveth the Barhumite;
 31 Abi-Albon the Arbathite, Azmaveth the Barhumite,
 32 Eliahba the Shaalbonite; Jashen the Gizonite; Jonathan son of
 32 Eliahba the Shaalbonite, the sons of Jashen, Jonathan
 33 Shammah the Hararite; Ahiam son of Sharar the Urite;
 33 son of Shammah the Hararite, Ahiam son of Sharar the Hararite,
 34 Eliphelet son of Ahasbai the Maacathite; Eliam son of Ahithophel the
 Gilonite;
 34 Eliphelet son of Ahasbai the Maacathite, Eliam son of Ahithophel the
 Gilonite,
 35 Hezro the Carmelite; Paarai the Arbite;
 35 Hezro the Carmelite, Paarai the Arbite,
 36 Igal son of Nathan, commander of the army of Hagrites;
 36 Igal son of Nathan from Zobah, the son of Hagri,
 37 Zelek the Ammonite; Naharai the Beerothite, weapon bearer of Joab son
 of Zeruiah;
 37 Zelek the Ammonite, Naharai the Beerothite, the armor-bearer of Joab
 son of Zeruiah,
 38 Ira the Ithrite; Gareb the Ithrite;
 38 Ira the Ithrite, Gareb the Ithrite
 39 Uriah the Hittite. Thirty-seven, all told.
 39 and Uriah the Hittite. There were thirty-seven in all.

2 Samuel 24

MSG

NIV

1 Once again GOD's anger blazed out against Israel. He tested David by
 telling him, "Go and take a census of Israel and Judah."

- 1 Again the anger of the LORD burned against Israel, and he incited David against them, saying, "Go and take a census of Israel and Judah."
- 2 So David gave orders to Joab and the army officers under him, "Canvass all the tribes of Israel, from Dan to Beersheba, and get a count of the population. I want to know the number."
- 2 So the king said to Joab and the army commanders with him, "Go throughout the tribes of Israel from Dan to Beersheba and enroll the fighting men, so that I may know how many there are."
- 3 But Joab resisted the king: "May your GOD multiply people by the hundreds right before the eyes of my master the king, but why on earth would you do a thing like this?"
- 3 But Joab replied to the king, "May the LORD your God multiply the troops a hundred times over, and may the eyes of my lord the king see it. But why does my lord the king want to do such a thing?"
- 4 Nevertheless, the king insisted, and so Joab and the army officers left the king to take a census of Israel.
- 4 The king's word, however, overruled Joab and the army commanders; so they left the presence of the king to enroll the fighting men of Israel.
- 5 They crossed the Jordan and began with Aroer and the town in the canyon of the Gadites near Jazer,
- 5 After crossing the Jordan, they camped near Aroer, south of the town in the gorge, and then went through Gad and on to Jazer.
- 6 proceeded through Gilead, passed Hermon, then on to Dan, but detoured Sidon.
- 6 They went to Gilead and the region of Tahtim Hodshi, and on to Dan Jaan and around toward Sidon.
- 7 They covered Fort Tyre and all the Hivite and Canaanite cities, and finally reached the Negev of Judah at Beersheba.
- 7 Then they went toward the fortress of Tyre and all the towns of the Hivites and Canaanites. Finally, they went on to Beersheba in the Negev of Judah.
- 8 They canvassed the whole country and after nine months and twenty days arrived back in Jerusalem.
- 8 After they had gone through the entire land, they came back to Jerusalem at the end of nine months and twenty days.

- 9 Joab gave the results of the census to the king: 800,000 able-bodied fighting men in Israel; in Judah 500,000.
- 9 Joab reported the number of the fighting men to the king: In Israel there were eight hundred thousand able-bodied men who could handle a sword, and in Judah five hundred thousand.
- 10 But when it was all done, David was overwhelmed with guilt because he had counted the people, replacing trust with statistics. And David prayed to GOD, "I have sinned badly in what I have just done. But now GOD forgive my guilt--I've been really stupid."
- 10 David was conscience-stricken after he had counted the fighting men, and he said to the LORD, "I have sinned greatly in what I have done. Now, O LORD, I beg you, take away the guilt of your servant. I have done a very foolish thing."
- 11 When David got up the next morning, the word of GOD had already come to Gad the prophet, David's spiritual advisor,
- 11 Before David got up the next morning, the word of the LORD had come to Gad the prophet, David's seer:
- 12 "Go and give David this message: 'GOD has spoken thus: There are three things I can do to you; choose one out of the three and I'll see that it's done.'"
- 12 Go and tell David, 'This is what the LORD says: I am giving you three options. Choose one of them for me to carry out against you.'
- 13 Gad came to deliver the message: "Do you want three years of famine in the land, or three months of running from your enemies while they chase you down, or three days of an epidemic on the country? Think it over and make up your mind. What shall I tell the one who sent me?"
- 13 So Gad went to David and said to him, "Shall there come upon you three years of famine in your land? Or three months of fleeing from your enemies while they pursue you? Or three days of plague in your land? Now then, think it over and decide how I should answer the one who sent me."
- 14 David told Gad, "They're all terrible! But I'd rather be punished by GOD, whose mercy is great, than fall into human hands."
- 14 David said to Gad, "I am in deep distress. Let us fall into the hands of the LORD, for his mercy is great; but do not let me fall into the hands of men."

- 15 So GOD let loose an epidemic from morning until suppertime. From Dan to Beersheba seventy thousand people died.
- 15 So the LORD sent a plague on Israel from that morning until the end of the time designated, and seventy thousand of the people from Dan to Beersheba died.
- 16 But when the angel reached out over Jerusalem to destroy it, GOD felt the pain of the terror and told the angel who was spreading death among the people, "Enough's enough! Pull back!" The angel of GOD had just reached the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite. David looked up and saw the angel hovering between earth and sky, sword drawn and about to strike Jerusalem. David and the elders bowed in prayer and covered themselves with rough burlap.
- 16 When the angel stretched out his hand to destroy Jerusalem, the LORD was grieved because of the calamity and said to the angel who was afflicting the people, "Enough! Withdraw your hand." The angel of the LORD was then at the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite.
- 17 When David saw the angel about to destroy the people, he prayed, "Please! I'm the one who sinned; I, the shepherd, did the wrong. But these sheep, what did they do wrong? Punish me and my family, not them."
- 17 When David saw the angel who was striking down the people, he said to the LORD, "I am the one who has sinned and done wrong. These are but sheep. What have they done? Let your hand fall upon me and my family."
- 18 That same day Gad came to David and said, "Go and build an altar on the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite."
- 18 On that day Gad went to David and said to him, "Go up and build an altar to the LORD on the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite."
- 19 David did what Gad told him, what GOD commanded.
- 19 So David went up, as the LORD had commanded through Gad.
- 20 Araunah looked up and saw David and his men coming his way; he met them, bowing deeply, honoring the king
- 20 When Araunah looked and saw the king and his men coming toward him, he went out and bowed down before the king with his face to the ground.

- 21 and saying, "Why has my master the king come to see me?" "To buy your threshing floor," said David, "so I can build an altar to GOD here and put an end to this disaster."
- 21 Araunah said, "Why has my lord the king come to his servant?" "To buy your threshing floor," David answered, "so I can build an altar to the LORD, that the plague on the people may be stopped."
- 22 "Oh," said Araunah, "let my master the king take and sacrifice whatever he wants. Look, here's an ox for the burnt offering and threshing paddles and ox-yokes for fuel--
- 22 Araunah said to David, "Let my lord the king take whatever pleases him and offer it up. Here are oxen for the burnt offering, and here are threshing sledges and ox yokes for the wood.
- 23 Araunah gives it all to the king! And may GOD, your God, act in your favor."
- 23 O king, Araunah gives all this to the king." Araunah also said to him, "May the LORD your God accept you."
- 24 But the king said to Araunah, "No. I've got to buy it from you for a good price; I'm not going to offer GOD, my God, sacrifices that are no sacrifice." So David bought the threshing floor and the ox, paying out fifty shekels of silver.
- 24 But the king replied to Araunah, "No, I insist on paying you for it. I will not sacrifice to the LORD my God burnt offerings that cost me nothing." So David bought the threshing floor and the oxen and paid fifty shekels of silver for them.
- 25 He built an altar to GOD there and sacrificed burnt offerings and peace offerings. GOD was moved by the prayers and that was the end of the disaster.
- 25 David built an altar to the LORD there and sacrificed burnt offerings and fellowship offerings. Then the LORD answered prayer in behalf of the land, and the plague on Israel was stopped.